Startup India Government Schemes — Complete Extraction

Source: https://www.startupindia.gov.in/content/sih/en/government-schemes.html **Extracted:** 2026-06-25 | **Total Schemes:** 69 | **Ministries:** 23

Summary by Ministry

Ministry/Organization	Schemes
Ministry of Science & Technology	11
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Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs Schemes	1
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Niti Aayog	1

All Schemes — Full Details

1. Central Sector Scheme on Conservation, Development and Sustainable Management of Medicinal Plants

Ministry: AYUSH

Sectors: Healthcare

Brief: The Ministry of Ayush has established a National Medicinal Plant Board to promote the development and cultivation of medicinal plants and to harmonize the development activities between several ministries/departments/organizations. The board has been implementing various schemes and policies for the MSMEs to grow, preserve, and market medicinal plants. Central Sector Scheme for Conservation, Development and Sustainable Management of Medicinal Plants is one such scheme launched by NMPB to focus on cultivation and protection of medicinal plants.

Benefits:

- Survey Inventorisation, In-situ Conservation through Medicinal Plants Conservation and Development Areas (MPCDA) and Resource augmentation
- Ex-situ Conservation / Establishment of Herbal Garden (HG), School Herbal Garden (SHG) and Home Herbal Garden (HHG)
- Support to Joint Forest Management Committees / Panchayats / Van Panchayats / Biodiversity Management Committees / Self Help Groups for value addition activities like drying, primary processing, storage, etc. of Medicinal Plants and thereby generate livelihood to these communities
- Research & Development.
- Information, Education, and Communication (IEC), etc.
- Promotional activities such as establishment of nurseries.

Benefit Tags: Regulatory

Tenure: Active

Notes:

- The Ministry of Ayush has established a National Medicinal Plant Board to promote the development and cultivation of medicinal plants and to harmonize the development activities between several ministries departments and organizations. The board has been implementing various schemes and policies for the MSMEs to grow, preserve, and market medicinal plants. Central Sector Scheme for Conservation, Development and Sustainable Management of Medicinal Plants is one such scheme launched by NMPB to focus on cultivation and protection of medicinal plants.

Apply: https://ngo.ayush.gov.in/national-medicinal-plant-board

2. BIRAC Incubators SEED Fund

Ministry: Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council (BIRAC)

Department: Department of Biotechnology (DBT)

Sectors: Biotechnology

Brief: The basic idea of SEED Fund is providing Capital assistance to startups with new and meritorious ideas, innovations and technologies. This would enable some of these start-ups to graduate to a level where they will be able to raise investments from angel/Venture capitalist or they will reach a position to seek loans from commercial banks /financial institutions. Thus the proposed seed support is positioned to act as a bridge between promoters investment and Venture/Angel investment. This is not an investment scheme, but, rather a support scheme to enable start-ups and incubator to attain sustainability.

Eligibility Criteria:

- **Incubator Eligibility :**
- Supported through BIRAC's Bio-NEST Programme.
- Operational for at least three years with at least five resident startups in Biotech/Med-Tech/Life Sciences.
- Established Intellectual Property & Technology Transfer (IP&TT) facilitation services.
- Prior experience managing early-stage funding schemes or grants.
- **Startup Eligibility :**
- Registered under Companies Act, 2013.
- At least 51% shareholding by Indian citizens (excluding OCI or PIO).
- Engaged in innovative and technology-driven projects relevant to biotechnology and life sciences.
- Demonstrate significant technical advancement and commercialization potential.

Benefits:

- It offers numerous benefits for both incubators and the startups they support. For incubators, it strengthens their capacity to nurture early-stage biotechnology ventures by providing financial resources for seed funding and attracting promising startups. This enhances their track record of successful portfolio companies and strengthens their position within the ecosystem. For startups, the SEED Fund alleviates the financial burden of early-stage development, enabling them to focus on critical activities like proof-of-concept demonstrations and initial market validation. Access to expertise and guidance from established incubators further accelerates their growth and increases their chances of success in the competitive biotechnology landscape.

Benefit Tags: Incubators

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- Each such selected incubator will be granted up to 200.00 Lakhs for implementation of SEED Fund. Each incubator can design a selection process to screen & select startups for equity and operational funding through SEED Fund (e.g Accelerator program or Direct investment).

Tenure: Active

Apply: https://birac.nic.in/seedFund.php

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3. Biotechnology Industry Partnership Program (BIPP)

Ministry: Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council (BIRAC)

Sectors: Agritech,Healthtech

Brief: The present scheme on Biotechnology Industry Partnership Programme (BIPP) is a government partnership with Industries for public support on a cost sharing basis for: · Path-breaking research in frontier futuristic technology areas having major economic potential and making Indian industry globally competitive and focused on IP creation with ownerships by Indian industry and where relevant, collaborating scientists. · The development of appropriate technologies in the context of recognized national priorities in the area of agriculture, health, bioenergy, green manufacturing, when the scale of the problem has serious consequences for social and economic development.

Eligibility Criteria:

- The proposals can be submitted by following · Single or consortia of Company (ies)* incorporated under the Companies Act, 2013 or Limited Liability Partnership (LLP)** incorporated under the Limited Liability Partnership Act, 2008 jointly with or without the following: Public/private university/colleges in India National research laboratories Not-for-profit private research labs/societies/foundation/NGO 2. 3. Eligibility Criteria · For Company/LLP:- * Minimum 51% of the shares of the Company should be held by Indian Citizens holding Indian passport [Indian Citizens do not include Person of Indian Origin (PIO) and Overseas Citizenship of India (OCI) holders] ** Minimum half of the persons who subscribed their names to the LLP document as its Partners should be Indian citizens. The Applicant Company/ LLP should: Have adequate in-house facility to address the project implementation(which shall be evaluated during the site visit) or Incubated at any of the recognized Incubation Facility · For Academic collaborator: Eligible Academia shall mean an entity which is having proper establishment documents For Public or Private Institute, University, NGO, or Research Foundation, proper registration/accreditation from a government body is mandatory like certification, AICTE, CSIR /DSIR/SIRO certificate etc.

Benefits:

- For Companies: Financial support: BIPP provides viability gap funding, sharing the costs of high-risk research projects with companies. This reduces the financial burden and encourages innovation.
- Access to expertise : Collaboration with academic and research institutions facilitated by BIPP provides companies with access to specialized knowledge and skills.
- Intellectual Property (IP) ownership : Companies retain ownership of the IP generated through their BIPP projects, giving them a competitive advantage.

Benefit Tags: Facilitation Support

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- Total fund disbursed: Rs. 523.79 Crore

Tenure: Active

Apply: https://birac.nic.in/desc_new.php?id=216

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4. Industry Innovation Programme on Medical Electronics (IIPME)

Ministry: Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council (BIRAC)

Sectors: MedTech

Brief: Industry Innovation Programme on Medical Electronics (IIPME) is a collaborative project between the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) and Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council (BIRAC), Department of Biotechnology, Ministry of Science & Technology, Government of India.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Indian startups which are less than three years old from date of advertisement which have 51% ownership, Indian LLPs and those which have Department of Scientific and Industrial Research (DSIR) Recognition (only for early transition & transition to scale) are eligible to apply under the scheme.

Benefits:

- **Mentorship and Guidance** : Access to experienced mentors and industry experts in medical electronics and related fields, providing valuable guidance on technology development, business strategy, and regulatory compliance.
- **Networking Opportunities** : Connection with potential investors, partners, and stakeholders within the medical electronics ecosystem, facilitating collaboration and market access.
- **Validation and Credibility** : Being selected for IIPME funding enhances a project's credibility and attracts further investment opportunities.
- **Infrastructure and Facilities** : Access to research facilities and equipment at designated incubators and partner institutions, reducing infrastructure overhead for startups.

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- **Seed Grants** - This is for funding the projects, which are at initial stages of product development cycle. These awards do not require preliminary data and are meant to provide an opportunity to test particularly bold ideas. A grant upto Rs. 50 lakhs for a period of 18 months can be provided in this category.

- **Early Transition** - This category is for projects which have established the proof of concept and require incremental prototype innovations and validation. These awards are for small risk projects which are at the early stages of translational research. A mix of grant & loan not exceeding INR 100 lakhs over the period of 24 can be provided in this category.

- **Transition to Scale**- The stage is for the projects which have already shown promising data on establishing the Proof of Concept and has generated enough validation data, these awards require demonstration of detailed preliminary data and are meant to provide an opportunity to develop, refine, and rigorously test approaches that have previously shown promise in controlled or limited settings. A mix of grant & loans for a period of 24 - 36 months is proposed. The project cost would be matched equally by Government Funds and the industry.

Tenure: Active

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5. SPARSH (Social Innovation program for Products: Affordable & Relevant to Societal Health)

Ministry: Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council (BIRAC)

Sectors: THEMES, MATERNAL AND CHILD HEALTH, AGEING AND HEALTH , FOOD AND NUTRITION , WASTE TO VALUE , AGRI-TECH , COMBATING ENVIRONMENTAL POLLUTION

Brief: SPARSH (Social Innovation Programme for Products: Affordable and Relevant to Societal Health) is the Social Innovation Programme of BIRAC aimed at promoting the development of innovative solutions to society’s most pressing social problems through biotechnological approaches. Since its inception, the program has been investing in high impact ideas and innovations that could address unmet needs and challenges that are neglected.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Biotechnology Indian startups that are incorporated under the Indian Companies Act, having a minimum of 51% Indian Ownership and less than three years old from the date of advertisement/Indian entrepreneurs.
- Limited Liability Partnership (LLP) that is incorporated under the Limited Liability Partnership Act, 2008, less than three years old from the date of advertisement and having a minimum half of the individuals who have subscribed for LLP document, whose partners have to be Indian citizens.
- Indian Academic Scientists, PhDs, Researchers, Medical Degree Holders, Biomedical Engineering graduates who are willing to incubate in a business incubator.
- Proprietorship concern that is set up by an Indian citizen under the certificate/license that is issued by municipal authorities/under Shop and Establishment Act or relevant prominence.

Benefits:

- SPARSH offers several benefits to innovators and entrepreneurs working on relevant healthcare solutions.

- **Mentorship and Guidance :** Access to expert mentors and advisors from diverse fields like healthcare, technology, business, and marketing.
- **Networking Opportunities :** Connection with potential investors, partners, and stakeholders within the healthcare ecosystem.
- **Market Access Support :** Assistance in navigating regulatory hurdles and finding pathways to reach target markets.
- **Brand Recognition and Credibility :** Being selected for SPARSH funding enhances a project's reputation and attracts further investment opportunities.

Benefit Tags: Infrastructure

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- The total budget allocated for SPARSH depends on the annual budgetary allocations of the Department of Biotechnology (DBT). However, it typically falls within the range of Rs. 100 crores to Rs. 200 crores per year. The specific funding allocated to each project depends on its scope, technical feasibility, and potential impact.

Tenure: Active

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6. CENT STAND UP INDIA

Ministry: Central Bank of India

Sectors: Manufacturing

Brief: CENT STAND UP INDIA is an initiative by the Central Bank of India aimed at supporting entrepreneurship and business initiatives for individuals and communities belonging to Scheduled Castes (SC) and Scheduled Tribes (ST). The purpose is to set up a new Green Field New Enterprise in the manufacturing, trading, or services sector by SC/ST/ Women entrepreneurs. Please note that the scheme is not applicable for existing units or expansion purposes.

Eligibility Criteria:

- SC/ST and /or Woman Entrepreneurs, above 18 years of age. In case of non-individual enterprises, 51% of the shareholding and controlling stake should be held by either SC/ST and/or Women Entrepreneur.

Benefits:

- The initiative offers financial support and guidance to eligible SC and ST individuals and businesses for starting or expanding their ventures.
- Participants gain access to funding, mentorship, and resources to help them succeed in entrepreneurship.
- For specific details about the initiative and its benefits, please visit the official website.

Benefit Tags: CC cum TL – composite loan

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- Max Finance 10 lakh to 1 CRORE
- Margin 25%
- Interest Rate Floating 7.80% to 12.40%
- Loan Term 84 months

Tenure: Active

Notes:

- For setting up a new Green Field New Enterprise in manufacturing, trading or services sector by SC ST Women entrepreneur.

Apply: https://www.centralbankofindia.co.in/en/cent-stand-up-india

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7. Cent Kalyani Scheme

Ministry: Central Bank of India

Sectors: Women Entrepreneuship

Brief: Cent-Kalyani is an initiative by the Central Bank of India aimed at empowering women entrepreneurs and businesses. This initiative is launched to encourage Women Entrepreneurs to start new projects or expand and modernize the existing unit.

Eligibility Criteria:

- New as well as Existing Women entrepreneurs for her Micro/Small enterprise (as defined under MSME Act- 2006) .i.e engaged in manufacturing and service activity for eg. Handloom weaving Handicraft, Food-Processing, Garment making, etc. Professionals & Self-employed women - Doctors, Chartered Accountants, and Engineers or trained in Art or Craft, etc.
- Health/Beauty/clinics/Dieticians/Fashion Designing Beauty Parlors. Small Business-Small/lunch/canteen, mobile restaurant, circulating/ library/tailoring/Day Creaches for children, Tailoring/Typing/STD/Xerox booth, etc.Transport Operators- Three wheelers/Four wheelers. (Retail Trade/Education and Training Institute/Self Help Group not eligible)

Benefits:

- Term Loan Fund Based Working capital Facility - Overdraft/Cash/Credit Non-Fund Based Working Capital - Letter of Credit/ Letter Of Guarantee etc
- For specific details about the initiative and its benefits, please visit the official website.

Benefit Tags: Credit Benefit

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- QUANTUM OF FINANCE: Maximum Rs. 100 Lacs.
- MARGIN: 20%
- RATE OF INTEREST: Concession in Rate of interest - Loan up to Rs. 10 Lacs - MCLR + 0.25% Loan above Rs. 10 Lacs and up to Rs.100 Lacs - MCLR + 0.50% Additional Interest concession of 0.25% if an account is rated by an external agency.

Notes:

- The scheme aims to encourage Women Entrepreneurs to start new projects or expand/modernize the existing unit. New as well as Existing Women entrepreneurs for their Micro / Small enterprises i.e engaged in manufacturing and service activity eg. Handloom weaving Handicraft, Professionals & Self-employed women - Doctors, Chartered Accountants, and Engineers or trained in Art or Craft, etc. Target Group-New, as well as Existing Women entrepreneurs for her Micro / Small enterprise (as defined under MSME Act- 2006), .i.e engaged in manufacturing and service activity for eg. Handloom weaving Handicraft, Food-Processing, Garment making, etc., etc. Professionals & Self-employed women - Doctors, Chartered Accountants, and Engineers or trained in Art or Craft, etc. Health /Beauty clinics/Dieticians/Fashion Designing Beauty Parlors.Small Business-Small lunch/canteen, mobile restaurant, circulating library/ tailoring /Day Creaches for children, Tailoring, Typing / STD/Xerox booth etc.Transport Operators- Three wheeler /Four wheeler. (Retail Trade/ Education and training Institute/ Self Help Group not eligible)

Apply: https://www.centralbankofindia.co.in/en/Cent_Kalyani

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8. Women Entrepreneur Cell

Ministry: Central Bank of India

Sectors: Agriculture, Retail

Brief: The Women Entrepreneur Cell is an initiative by the Central Bank of India dedicated to supporting and promoting women entrepreneurs. The aim is to emerge as a key player for Women Empowerment by enhancing their capabilities in Entrepreneurship, Responsive to their special credit needs, and offering them the best financial services and best Banking practices.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Women Entrepreneurs are eligible for this scheme.

Benefits:

- Cater to women entrepreneurs across all levels of economic activity, with a focus on MSMEs, agriculture, and retail sectors in alignment with government priorities.
- Participants gain access to funding, expert guidance, and a supportive community of women entrepreneurs.
- To support new and existing Women Entrepreneurs in the expansion and modernization of their unit.

Benefit Tags: Funding

Tenure: Active

Notes:

- To cater to Women Entrepreneurs at all levels of Economic activity with emphasis on MSME, Agriculture, and Retail in sinc with Govt. priorities.
- To identify, encourage, and assist aspiring Women Entrepreneurs to start an Enterprise professionally.
- To guide and support existing Women Entrepreneurs in the expansion and modernization of their unit.
- To coordinate with Government Non-Government Organisations Association to bring more and more Women Entrepreneurs into Bank's fold.

Apply: https://www.centralbankofindia.co.in/en/Women_Entrepreneur_Cell

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9. Agriculture Infrastructure Fund for Agripreneurs

Ministry: Ministry of Agriculture

Sectors: Agriculture

Brief: The Department of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare, Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare, Govt. of India has formulated the Central Sector Scheme with an objective to mobilize a medium long-term debt financing facility for investment in viable projects relating to post-harvest management Infrastructure and community farming assets through incentives and financial support in order to improve agriculture infrastructure in the country.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Post Harvest Management Projects
- Projects on Hub and Spoke Model
- Viable Projects for Building Community Farming Assets

Benefits:

- All loans under this financing facility will have interest subvention of 3% per annum up to a limit of Rs. 2 crore. This subvention will be available for a maximum period of seven years.
- Further, credit guarantee coverage will be available for eligible borrowers from this financing facility under the Credit Guarantee Fund Trust for Micro and Small Enterprises (CGTMSE) scheme for a loan up to Rs. 2 crore. The fee for this coverage will be paid by the Government.
- In case of FPOs, the credit guarantee may be availed from the facility created under the FPO promotion scheme of the Department of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare (DA&FW).
- Moratorium for repayment under this financing facility may vary subject to a minimum of 6 months and a maximum of 2 years.

Benefit Tags: Credit Benefit

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- Rs. 1 lakh Crore, to be released on FCFS basis; up to 25 projects per individual beneficiary in diff. locations

Tenure: 2020-21 to 2029-30 loan disbursement period will be between 2020-21 and 2023-24. Interest subvention and credit guarantee for a loan will be applicable only for 7 years from the date of the first disbursement of the loan.

Notes:

- With the launch of Agriculture Infrastructure Fund, the trained and established agripreneurs have got an opportunity to establish a new unit or scale up the operations of the existing one. With Credit Guarantee, incentive and interest subvention lending institutions will be able to lend with a lower risk to Agripreneurs which was a hurdle earlier. With a dedicated source of funding, agripreneurs can push for innovation in the agriculture sector by leveraging new-age technologies including IoT, AI, etc It will also connect the players in the ecosystem and hence, improve avenues for collaboration between agripreneurs and farmers.

Apply: https://www.manage.gov.in/aif/AIF%20Brochure.pdf

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10. AGNIi

Ministry: Ministry of Commerce and Industry Schemes

Department: Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)

Sectors: Technology

Brief: AGNIi convenes India's finest technologists and their deployment-ready technologies - from startups and laboratories - with top technology users from Indian and global enterprise, government, and non-profit sectors. And help those who have the technology, deliver it where it is needed. We help those who need technology, find it.

Eligibility Criteria:

- **Institutional Affiliation :**
- Indian universities, research institutions, or innovative startups.
- Strong research and development infrastructure and capabilities.
- Proven track record in innovation and technology development.

Benefits:

- Grants and Funding Flexibility

Benefit Tags: Funding

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- Amount for the grant provided by the AGNIi scheme, varies depending on the type of the scheme. But Minimum : As low as INR 10 lakhs (approx. USD 13,300) for sub-schemes like Early Stage Catalyst, focused on supporting proof-of-concept and early-stage development. And maximum: Grand Challenge sub-scheme: Up to INR 20 crore (approx. USD 2.6 million) per project for addressing specific technological challenges

Tenure: Active

Apply: https://www.investindia.gov.in/

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11. Niryat Bandhu Scheme

Ministry: Ministry of Commerce and Industry Schemes

Department: DOC

Sectors: Export

Brief: Niryat Bandhu Scheme is an online certificate program. It is an export-import business under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry for International Business. Digital India and Skill India are the twin objectives of the “Niryat Bandhu Scheme.” The program is implemented by the Director-General of Foreign Trade in collaboration with the Indian Institute of Foreign Trade (IIFT). The field officer’s primary function is mentoring the field and would be a hand-holding experiment for the young in international business enterprises.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Any person can take this Course

Benefits:

- Know-how about Import and Export and a Certificate that you can share with prospective employers and your professional network.
- Certification: When you finish every module, you can earn a Certificate that you can share with prospective employers and your professional network, after taking the online tests and payment of Examination/ Certification fees which is Rs 2000.

Benefit Tags: Mentorship

Tenure: Active

Notes:

- This scheme is an outreach program to mentor and guide potential and new exporters. The scheme provides training, counseling, and handholding support to entrepreneurs who want to start or expand their export business. The scheme also leverages digital platforms and online courses to reach out to a wider audience

Apply: https://niryatbandhu.iift.ac.in/exim/

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12. Participation in International Fairs and Exhibitions with Tea Board

Ministry: Ministry of Commerce and Industry Schemes

Department: Tea Board of India

Sectors: Export

Brief: To provide a platform to the exporters to showcase their products in international events for promotion and facilitate the generation of trade opportunities through interaction between buyers and sellers during the exhibition.

Eligibility Criteria:

- All exporters holding valid exporters' licenses are eligible to participate from the Tea Board's booth in the exhibition. The company shall not be under any investigation/charged/prosecuted/debarred/blacklisted on any grounds related to trade and business.
- Only exporters submitting regular monthly export returns will be eligible for participation.
- The exporter must be dealing in only 100% Indian teas.
- Provision for new entrants will be there as per the table at C 2 below.

Benefits:

- Provides a platform for the exporters to showcase their products in international events for promotion and facilitate the generation of trade opportunities through interaction between buyers and sellers during the exhibition.

Benefit Tags: Regulatory

Apply: http://www.teaboard.gov.in/pdf/Revised_Scheme_for_Participation_in_International_fairs_and_exhibitions_with_Tea_Board_29_11_17_pdf2688.pdf

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13. Digital Communication Innovation Square

Ministry: Ministry of Communications

Department: Department of Telecommunications

Sectors: Communication

Brief: The Digital Communication Innovation Square (DCIS) is an initiative that is intended to catalyze startup culture and build a strong and inclusive ecosystem for innovation and entrepreneurship in India. TCOE India is implementing the Scheme on behalf of the Department of Telecom. The Implementing Agency (IA) is working under the overall supervision of the Apex Committee and guidelines issued by the DoT.

Eligibility Criteria:

- The Digital Communication Innovation Square (DCIS) is open to startups defined by DPIIT and are working towards development or improvement of products and processes with scalable business models.
- Specific eligibility requirements can be viewed in the official document of the policy.

Benefits:

- DCIS offers a platform for innovators to showcase their digital communication solutions and ideas.
- Benefits include assistance in research, design, development, proof of concept testing, IPR creation, pilot project, and manufacturing i.e. complete value chain to make India a global hub for the production of telecommunication equipment and a center for digital communication services.
- For specific details about DCIS and its offerings, please visit the official website.

Benefit Tags: Regulatory

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- 124 Crs of Budget Outlay

Tenure: Active

Notes:

- To promote the ecosystem for research, design, development, proof of concept testing, Minimum Viable Product (MVP), Intellectual Property Rights (IPR) creation, pilot project, and manufacturing i.e. complete value chain to make India a global hub for the production of telecommunication equipment and a center for digital communication services.

Apply: https://dcis.dot.gov.in/assets/document/DCIS_Guidelines-2023.pdf

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14. Innovations for Defence Excellence (iDEX)

Ministry: Ministry of Defence

Department: Department of Defence Production

Sectors: Defence

Brief: The iDEX initiative was launched by the Hon'ble PM in April 2018. iDEX aims to achieve self-reliance and foster innovation and technology development in Defence and Aerospace by engaging Industries including MSMEs, start-ups, individual innovators, R&D institutes and academia.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Start-ups, as defined and recognized by Department of Industrial Policy and Promotion (DIPP), Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Government of India
- Any Indian company incorporated under the Companies Act 1956/2013, primarily a Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME) as defined in the MSME Act, 2006.
- Individual innovators are also encouraged to apply (research & academic institutions can use this category to apply).

Benefits:

- The objective of the scheme is to provide financial support to nearly 300 Startups MSMEs individual innovators and about 20 Partner incubators through Defence Innovation Organisation (DIO).

Benefit Tags: Cash Benefit Schemes

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- Rs 498 crore for 5 years

Tenure: 2021-22 to 2025-26

Notes:

- The Department of Defence Production, Ministry of Defence has approved a central sector scheme viz. Innovations for Defence Excellence (iDEX)with budgetary support of Rs498.78 crore for the next 5 years from 2021-22 to 2025-26. The objective of the scheme is to provide financial support to nearly 300 Startups MSMEs individual innovators and about 20 Partner incubators through the Defence Innovation Organisation (DIO). Innovations for Defence Excellence (iDEX) framework aims to achieve self-reliance and foster innovation and technology development in the Defence and Aerospace Sector by engaging Industries including MSMEs, startups, individual innovators, R&D institutes, and academia.

Apply: https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1782604

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15. Technology Development Fund

Ministry: Ministry of Defence

Department: DRDO

Sectors: Defence

Brief: The TDF Scheme extends financial support and expertise to upgrade existing products/systems, processes, and applications by reducing production costs, improving functionality and quality by promoting Make in India, and the development of futuristic technologies with defense applications. The Scheme enlists requirements of Service Headquarters of upgrading products/systems and futuristic defense technologies as Projects for which eligible stakeholders can apply through this platform.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Eligibility for Industry Private industry registered in India especially MSMEs and Startups The industry must be a public limited company, a private limited company, a partnership firm, a limited liability partnership, one-person company, sole proprietorship registered as per applicable Indian laws Industry to be owned and controlled by a Resident Indian Citizen with a shareholding of at least 51%

Benefits:

- Financial Support and expertise to upgrade existing products/systems

Apply: https://tdf.drdo.gov.in

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16. Equipment Finance (Northeastern Development Finance Corporation Ltd Schemes)

Ministry: Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region

Department: Development of North-eastern Region

Brief: This scheme intends to provide financial assistance for acquiring specific machinery/ equipment by financially sound and profit-making companies having a good credit record. The proposed unit should be located in any of the eight North Eastern States.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Corporates with minimum 3 years of profitable operations for NEDFi assisted units, in case of other units the unit should have minimum 5 years of operations.

Benefits:

- Minimum: Rs.25 lakh, Maximum: Rs.10 Crores financial assistance

Apply: https://my.msme.gov.in/MyMsmeMob/MsmeScheme/NorthEasternDevlop.htm

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17. Equity Fund Scheme (NEDFi)

Ministry: Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region

Department: NEDFL

Sectors: Sector Agnostic

Brief: The schemes intend to invest in projects promoted by entrepreneurs in the North-Eastern Region having sound business ideas with potential for high growth and more than normal returns on investment.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Individual entrepreneurs or groups of entrepreneurs; The applicant should have a viable business plan which offers above-average profitability leading to attractive returns on investment.

Benefits:

- Investment in a single project would range from Rs.50-300 lakhs. Assistance will be available for financing terms normally included in the cost of a project, startup working capital, and selectively for core current assets during commercial operation.

Apply: https://my.msme.gov.in/MyMsmeMob/MsmeScheme/Pages/7_1_4.html

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18. Micro Finance (NEDFL Scheme)

Ministry: Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region

Department: NEDFL

Sectors: Sector Agnostic

Brief: The scheme envisages meeting micro-credit needs small and medium size agriculturists, self-employed personnel and entrepreneurs can be reached much more effectively by involving the services of intermediaries, who can understand needs, demand, and local situations. Developing and supporting NGOs/ Voluntary Agencies (VAs) with a good track record for on-lending to the 'needy' for taking up any income generating activities in the rural areas.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Any Indian Citizen with 40% or more disability
- Age above 18 years.
- The borrowers already covered under any other scheme of financing sponsored by Central or State Government or financing institutions and having outstanding loans against their names shall not be eligible.
- The borrowers should preferably be regular members of Thrift and Credit Group (Self Help Group).
- Preference will be given to women beneficiaries.
- Relevant educational/technical/vocational qualification, experience, and background.

Benefits:

- Rs.10.0 lakh (Rupees Ten Lakh only).

Apply: http://nhfdc.nic.in/schemes/micro-financing-scheme

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19. North East Entrepreneurs Development (NEED)

Ministry: Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region

Sectors: North East

Brief: The North East Entrepreneurs Development (NEED) initiative is an effort by the Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region to support entrepreneurship and business development in the North Eastern Region of India. The scheme has been formulated to help first-generation entrepreneurs who are short of equity. New projects in Micro and Small Enterprises, expansion, and modernization of existing units. Technical qualification of the promoter in the relevant field is a pre-requisite.

Eligibility Criteria:

- First-generation entrepreneurs, existing entrepreneurs, proprietary & partnership concerns and companies. Technical qualification of the promoter in the relevant field is a pre-requisite.

Benefits:

- Term loan up to a maximum of 75% of the project cost including one cycle of working capital in deserving cases. Promoter's contribution minimum of 25% of the project cost.
- For specific details about NEED and its benefits, please visit the official website.

Benefit Tags: Credit Benefit Schemes

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- For Incubation group Rs 3 lakhs commercialization grant for 120 startups, additional Rs.7 lakhs for top 20 performers
- For Pre-incubation group Rs 1 lakhs prototype grant for 150 startups, additional Rs.4 lakhs for top 25 performers.

Tenure: Active

Notes:

- The scheme has been formulated to help first-generation entrepreneurs who are short of equity. New projects in Micro and Small Enterprises, expansion, and modernization of existing units. Technical qualification of the promoter in the relevant field is a pre-requisite.

Apply: https://my.msme.gov.in/MyMsmeMob/MsmeScheme/Pages/7_1_6.html

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20. North-East Handloom Handicrafts (NEHH)

Ministry: Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region

Department: North-East Handloom Handicrafts (NEHH)

Sectors: Technology

Brief: The North-East Handloom Handicrafts (NEHH) initiative is an endeavor by the Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region. The aim is to promote enterprises in handlooms and handicrafts sector and provide a platform for sustainable economic growth by promoting the local artisans.

Eligibility Criteria:

- The North-East Handloom Handicrafts (NEHH) initiative is open to individuals, artisans, handloom weavers, and handicraft producers in the North Eastern Region of India.
- Applicants should be interested in promoting and enhancing their handloom and handicrafts businesses.
- Specific eligibility requirements may vary based on the programs and opportunities offered under NEHH.

Benefits:

- This scheme provides benefits like fostering innovation and research through Technology Development Funds, safeguarding intellectual property with Patent Protection Funds, accessing external technologies via Technology In-Licensing Funds, mitigating risks during scaling with Technology Scale-up Validation De-risking Funds, expanding into new markets using Market Entry Funds, and fueling growth through Expansion Funds.
- For specific details about NEHH and its benefits, please visit the official website.

Benefit Tags: Credit Benefit

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- NSDF has released Rs. 5029.63 crores to NSDC towards skill development programs including National Skill Certification and Monetary Reward Scheme (STAR) and UDAAN Scheme (J&K oriented).

Tenure: Active

Notes:

- The scheme aims to promote enterprises in handlooms and handicrafts sector and provide a platform for sustainable economic growth by promoting the local artisans.

Apply: http://funding.venturecenter.co.in/viewrecord.php?srn=BI20200724084616

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21. North-East Venture Fund (NEVF)

Ministry: Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region

Brief: Set up by North-Eastern Development Finance Corporation Limited (NEDFi) in association with the Ministry of Development of North-Eastern Region (M-DoNER), the North-East Venture Fund scheme was launched in September 2017. It is the first dedicated venture capital fund for the North-Eastern Region (NER).

Eligibility Criteria:

- Entrepreneurial person with innovative vision and implementation power
- Strong management team and commitment
- Viable business model with sustainable growth
- Large scaling opportunities
- Market-fit product with good traction
- Realistic exit potential

Benefits:

- Corpus of Fund equal to Rs 100 crore.
- The investment under this scheme ranges from Rs. 25 lakhs to Rs.10 crore per venture, which is long term in nature with an investment horizon of 4-5 years.

Benefit Tags: Funding

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- target corpus of Rs. 100 crore

Tenure: Active

Notes:

- The Ministry of Development of the North-Eastern Region (DoNER) along with the North-Eastern Development Finance Corporation Ltd. (NEDFi) has set up the North-East Venture Fund (NEVF). The main aim of collecting this fund is to use it in certain development projects in the North-East. The DoNER has aimed to collect Rs 100 crore under the NEVF out of which 45 crores will be contributed by DoNER, 30 crore by NEVF, and the rest principal amount will be contributed by the Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI). The collected fund is to be invested in different sectors by a committee of experts including bankers, financial advisors, and investors. Till now Rs. 1092.5 lacs has already been invested in start-ups in various sectors from health, technology, tourism, media, etc.

Apply: https://www.nedfiventure.com/funds/

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22. Women Enterprise Development (WED)

Ministry: Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region

Brief: The scheme provides financial assistance to women entrepreneurs for taking up business ventures. Existing businesses will also be eligible for expansion, modernization, and diversification.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Skilled woman entrepreneurs in the age group of 18-50 years; the applicant must be engaged in any viable income generating activity including small business trade., etc.

Benefits:

- Financial Assistance of Maximum Rs. 100 Lacs.

Apply: https://my.msme.gov.in/MyMsmeMob/MsmeScheme/Pages/7_1_11.html

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23. Working Capital Term Loan (WCTL)

Ministry: Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region

Brief: NEDFi provides financial assistance in the form of gap funding to eligible contractor firms companies for contract work execution. Working capital term loan assistance is given in the form of gap funding. Interest rate is fixed based on prime lending rate with plus or spread as per the credit worthiness of the borrower, risk perception, rating, and other relevant factors.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Eligible contractor firms and companies.

Benefits:

- Financial assistance in the form of gap funding

Benefit Tags: Credit Benefit

Tenure: Active

Notes:

- NEDFi provides financial assistance in the form of gap funding to eligible contractor firms companies for contract work execution. Working capital term loan assistance is given in the form of gap funding. Interest rate is fixed on the basis of prime lending rate with plus or spread as per the creditworthiness of the borrower, risk perception, rating, and other relevant factors.

Apply: https://www.federalbank.co.in/corporate-finance/working-capital-term-loan#:~:text=Working%20Capital%20Term%20Loan%20(WCTL)%20is%20provided%20to%20extend%20long,capital%20credit%20facilities%20to%20entrepreneurs.

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24. Working Capital Term Loan (WCTL) for Contract Finance

Ministry: Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region

Brief: NEDFi provides financial assistance in the form of gap funding to eligible contractor firms/companies for contract work execution. Working capital term loan assistance is given in the form of gap funding. Interest rate is fixed based on prime lending rate with plus or spread as per the credit worthiness of the borrower, risk perception, rating, and other relevant factors.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Eligible contractor firms and companies.

Benefits:

- Financial assistance in the form of gap funding

Apply: https://my.msme.gov.in/MyMsmeMob/MsmeScheme/Pages/7_1_10.html

25. Domain-specific Centres of Excellence

Ministry: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)

Sectors: Deep Tech/Technology

Brief: MeitY had envisaged and operationalized a clutch of Centres of Excellence (CoEs) in diverse areas of national interest pan India providing a focal point for knowledge management, driving self-sufficiency, and creating capabilities to capture new and emerging technology areas. These domain-specific Centres of Excellence (CoEs) are made operational with the participation of MeitY, STPI, State Governments, Industries, and VCs.

Benefits:

- COE in FinTech at STPI-Chennai provides infrastructure, resources, coaching mentorship, technology support, and funding to emerging startups in the FinTech sector.
- The IoT OpenLab intends to support 500 startups over a period of 5 years in the IoT to develop disruptive applications, products, and or services and give networking opportunities to the startups.
- The ESDM Incubation Centre at Bhubaneswar supports the creation of a holistic eco-system to promote ESDM innovation, R&D and help generate intellectual property in the eastern region.
- Medi-Electronics & Health Informatics CoE at SGPGI Lucknow has been established to stimulate the establishment and growth of technology-based startups in the field of medical electronics and health informatics by providing the necessary infrastructure, mentoring, marketing, funding, and eco-system.
- The aim of the Centre of Excellence in Intellectual Property is to encourage the growth of IP in ICT by way of creating a conducive framework for the identification, protection, and monetization of IPRs.

Benefit Tags: Infrastructure

Tenure: Over a period of 5 years from 07.12.2018 (ADMINISTRATIVE APPROVAL) i.e valid till 07.12.2023. subject to extension

Notes:

- The MeitY has envisaged and operationalized 26 Centres of Excellence (CoEs) in diverse areas of national interest for driving self-sufficiency and creating capabilities to capture new and emerging technology areas. These domain-specific CoEs act as enablers and aid in making India an innovation hub in emerging through the democratization of innovation and realization of prototypes.

Apply: https://www.meity.gov.in/content/centres-excellence-coe-projects

26. Duty Exemption And Remission Scheme

Ministry: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)

Sectors: Import

Brief: The scheme enables duty-free import of inputs for export production, including replenishment of inputs or duty remission.

Benefit Tags: Facilitation Benefit

Apply: https://content.dgft.gov.in/Website/FTP%20Chapter%204%20as%20on%20June%2030%202019.pdf

27. Electronics Hardware Technology Park Scheme

Ministry: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)

Sectors: Hardware

Brief: The STP (Software Technology Park) and EHTP (Electronic Hardware Technology Park) schemes are initiatives aimed at promoting software and electronics hardware development for exports in India. These schemes provide specific benefits and eligibility criteria for interested units.

Benefits:

- The scheme offers benefits such as duty-free import of capital goods and raw materials, simplified customs procedures, and tax incentives for eligible businesses.
- Units operating under the STP and EHTP schemes are entitled to import specified goods duty-free, reducing operational costs and promoting the development of software and electronics hardware for exports.
- For specific details about the scheme and its benefits, please refer to the official document.

Benefit Tags: Regulatory

Tenure: Active

Apply: https://taxindiaonline.com/RC2/pdfdocs/cm/cm22d.pdf

28. Genesis

Ministry: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)

Sectors: Deep Tech/Technology

Brief: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) has launched an umbrella program Digital India-GENESIS to discover, support, grow, and make successful startups in Tier-II and Tier-III cities with emphasis on collaborative engagement among startups, government, and corporates for promoting digitization based on the principals of inclusivity, accessibility, affordability, leading to growth in employment and economic outputs.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Eligibility Criteria for Implementation Agency:
- Organisation and institutions that are based out of Tier II and Tier III cities of India, are eligible to apply for this scheme.
- Eligible entities include startup incubators, accelerators, investment platforms, entrepreneurship-supporting organizations, and academic R&D institutions that have intent, expertise, and allocation of resources to support student entrepreneurs and innovators in their local community.

Benefits:

- This program will help startups expand globally by leveraging the equity-linked seed investment dispersed through this initiative.

Benefit Tags: Funding

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- 490 Cr for 5 years

Tenure: 2022-2027

Notes:

- Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) has launched an umbrella program Digital India-GENESIS to discover, support, grow and make successful startups in Tier-II and Tier-III cities with emphasis on collaborative engagement among startups, government, and corporates for promoting digitization based on the principals of inclusivity, accessibility, affordability, leading to growth in employment and economic outputs.

Apply: https://msh.meity.gov.in/assets/About%20GENESIS_Scheme.pdf

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29. Software Technology Park (STP) Scheme

Ministry: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)

Department: Software Technology Parks of India (STPI)

Sectors: IT and Service Sector

Brief: The STP Scheme is a 100% export-oriented scheme for the development and export of computer software, including export of professional services using communication links or physical media. As a unique scheme, it focuses on one sector, i.e. computer software. The scheme integrates the government concept of 100% Export Oriented Units (EOU) and Export Processing Zones (EPZ) and the concept of Science Parks/Technology Parks, as operating elsewhere in the world.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Company Registration: Registered under the Companies Act, 2013, or as a Limited Liability Partnership (LLP).
- **Minimum Export Turnover :** At least 50% of the annual turnover must be earned from export of software or IT services, hardware exports, or AVGC content.
- **Technology Focus :** Primarily engaged in development and/or delivery of technology-driven services or products.
- **Other Compliance :** Meet additional criteria related to net positive foreign exchange earnings, minimum investment in infrastructure, and adherence to statutory regulations.

Benefits:

- **Benefits of Software Technology Scheme :**
- Projects that cost Rs.100 million or less with Indian investment are cleared by jurisdictional software technology park scheme authorities.
- It permits 100 percent foreign equity.
- All hardware and software imports into STP units are duty-free, and the import of second-hand capital goods is also permitted.
- Capital goods re-export is permitted.
- Capital goods purchased from the Domestic Tariff Area are eligible for benefits such as excise duty exemption and reimbursement of Central Sales Tax.
- Capital invested by foreign entrepreneurs, such as know-how fees, royalties, and dividends, can be freely repatriated after payment of income taxes due.

Benefit Tags: Facilitation Benefits

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- **The STP scheme primarily offers indirect financial benefits through :**
- Duty exemption on import of hardware and software
- Tax benefits
- Single window clearance
- Infrastructure facilities

Tenure: Active

Apply: https://stpi.in/en/stp-scheme

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30. Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana

Ministry: Ministry of Finance

Department: Department of Financial Services

Sectors: Manufacturing, processing, trading or service sector

Brief: The scheme was launched on 8th April 2015. Under the scheme a loan of up to Rs. 50,000 is given under sub-scheme ‘Shishu’; between Rs. 50,000 to 5.0 Lakhs under sub-scheme ‘Kishore’; and between 5.0 Lakhs to 10.0 Lakhs under sub-scheme ‘Tarun’. Loans taken do not require collaterals. These measures are aimed at increasing the confidence of young, educated or skilled workers who would now be able to aspire to become first-generation entrepreneurs; existing small businesses, too, will be able to expand their activities.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Eligible borrowers : Individuals
- Proprietary concern.
- Partnership Firm.
- Private Ltd.
- Company.
- Public Company.
- Any other legal forms.
- The applicant should not be defaulter to any bank or financial institution and should have a satisfactory credit track record. The individual borrowers may be required to possess the necessary skills experience knowledge to undertake the proposed activity. The need for educational qualification, if any, needs to be assessed based on the nature of the proposed activity, and its requirement

Benefits:

- The benefits under the scheme have been classified under three categories as 'SHISHU','KISHOR'and'TARUN'to signify the stage of growth/development and funding needs of the beneficiary micro unit/entrepreneur.
- Shishu: Covering loans up to Rs. 50,000/-
- Kishor: Covering loans from Rs. 50,001 to Rs. 5,00,000/-
- Tarun: Covering loans from Rs. 5,00,001 to Rs. 10,00,000/-

Benefit Tags: Cash Benefit Schemes

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- Sanctioned Amount in 2023: 311811.38 Cr

Tenure: Active

Notes:

- The scheme was launched on 8th April 2015. Under the scheme a loan of up to Rs. 50,000 is given under sub-scheme 'Shishu'; between Rs. 50,000 to 5.0 Lakhs under sub-scheme 'Kishore'; and between 5.0 Lakhs to 10.0 Lakhs under sub-scheme 'Tarun'. Loans taken do not require collaterals. These measures are aimed at increasing the confidence of young, educated, or skilled workers who would now be able to aspire to become first-generation entrepreneurs; existing small businesses, too, will be able to expand their activities. As of 20.08.2021, Rs. 16,22,203 crores sanctioned in 30.7 crores accounts.

Apply: https://www.mudra.org.in/

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31. SIDBI Make in India Soft Loan Fund for Micro Small and Medium Enterprises (SMILE)

Ministry: Ministry of Finance

Department: SIDBI

Sectors: MSME

Brief: SIDBI Make in India Soft Loan Fund for Micro Small and Medium Enterprises (SMILE) was initiated by the Government of India to make MSMEs take an active part in the 'Make in India' campaign. The primary focus is to provide financing to small enterprises within the MSME sector. The term Soft Loan was introduced to offer loans with Soft terms to meet the debt-equity ratio for the establishment of an MSME.

Eligibility Criteria:

- **Eligibility Criteria for SMILE :**
- The majority emphasis will be on covering newly emerged enterprises in the manufacturing and service sector
- The primary emphasis will be on financing smaller famous enterprises within the MSME sector
- All the existing enterprises are undertaking expansion to take advantage of newly emerged opportunities along with modernization of technology up gradation techniques
- Regarding the SMILE Equipment Finance (SEF), the MSME entities should be in existence for at least 3 years having a satisfactory financial position.

Benefits:

- **Key Features & Benefits :**
- Attractive interest rates
- Comparatively more extended periods of loan repayment
- Speedy dispensation of financial assistance
- Efficient funding of partial promoter contribution by methods of soft loans
- Speedy dispensation of machinery loan through the contactless platform
- In the case of SMILE equipment finance, there exists a lower amount of promoter contribution

Benefit Tags: Loan

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- Min. Loan Amount - Rs.10 lakh for equipment finance.
- Max. Loan Amount - Rs. 25 lakh

Tenure: Active

Apply: https://www.paisabazaar.com/business-loan/sidbi-smile-scheme/

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32. Swarojgar Credit Card

Ministry: Ministry of Finance

Sectors: Micro-entrepreneurs

Brief: The Swarojgar Credit Card scheme is an initiative by the Ministry of Finance aimed at providing easy access to credit for small entrepreneurs and self-employed individuals in India. SCC Scheme aims at providing adequate and timely credit ie. working/capital or blocks capital or both to small artisans, handloom weavers, service sector, fishermen, self-employed persons, rickshaw owners, other micro-entrepreneurs, etc. from the banking system in flexible, hassle-free and cost-effective manner. The facility may also include a reasonable component for consumption needs.

Eligibility Criteria:

- The Swarojgar Credit Card scheme is open to small entrepreneurs, self-employed individuals, and small businesses in India.
- Specific eligibility requirements may vary based on the lending institutions and financial regulations.

Benefits:

- The scheme provides access to credit facilities, allowing eligible individuals and businesses to secure funds for their entrepreneurial and self-employment ventures.
- Providing Access to Credit for Small Entrepreneurs and Self-Employed Individuals.
- Participants gain access to credit on favorable terms, simplified documentation, and flexibility in repaying loans.
- For specific details about the scheme and its benefits, please refer to the official notification.

Benefit Tags: Credit Benefit

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- Rs. 25,000 per borrower as composite loan.

Tenure: Active

Notes:

- SCC Scheme aims at providing adequate and timely credit ie. working capital or block capital or both to small artisans, handloom weavers, service sector, fishermen, self-employed persons, rickshaw owners, other micro-entrepreneurs, etc. from the banking system in a flexible, hassle-free and cost-effective manner. The facility may also include a reasonable component for consumption needs.

Apply: https://www.rbi.org.in/Scripts/NotificationUser.aspx?Id=1373

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33. Agro-Processing Cluster Scheme

Ministry: Ministry of Food Processing Industries

Sectors: Food Processing Sector

Brief: The scheme aims at the development of modern infrastructure and common facilities to encourage a group of entrepreneurs to set up food processing units based on cluster approach by linking groups of producers farmers to the processors and markets through a well-equipped supply chain with modern infrastructure.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Eligible entities:
- Agro Processing Cluster Projects can be set up by an entity organization such as Govt. Departments PSUs Joint Ventures NGOS Cooperatives Self Help Groups (SHGs) Farmer Producer Organisation (FPOS) Private Sector Companies Partnership Firms Proprietorship Firms etc.
- For more detailed information regarding eligibility criteria, please refer to the guidelines document from the link below.

Benefits:

- The Scheme envisages grants-in-aid @ 35% of eligible project cost in general areas and @50% of eligible project cost in the North East States including Sikkim and difficult areas namely Himalayan States (i.e. Himachal Pradesh, Jammu & Kashmir, and Uttarakhand), State notified ITDP areas, Islands and SC ST entrepreneurs subject to max. of Rs. 10.00 crore per project.

Benefit Tags: Infrastructure

Notes:

- This is a centrally sponsored scheme that provides grants-in-aid to entrepreneurs for setting up agro-processing clusters that include common facilities such as sorting, grading, packaging, warehousing, etc. The scheme also supports farmer-producer organizations, self-help groups, and cooperatives in the clusters. The scheme has an allocation of Rs. 200 crore for 2020-21.

Apply: https://www.mofpi.gov.in/Schemes/agro-processing-cluster

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34. Creation/Expansion of Food Processing & Preservation Capacities (CEFPPC) scheme

Ministry: Ministry of Food Processing Industries

Sectors: Food Processing Sector

Brief: The main objective of the Scheme is the creation of processing and preservation capacities and modernization/ expansion of existing food processing units with a view to increasing the level of processing, and value addition leading to reduction of wastage. The processing activities undertaken by the individual units cover a wide range of post-harvest processes resulting in value addition and/or enhancing shelf life with specialized facilities required for preservation of perishables. While the expansion of processing capacity is necessary to increase the level of processing and reduce wastage, the induction of modern technology is intended to make a clear difference in terms of process efficiencies as well as improving the quality of the end product. The setting up of new units and modernization/ expansion of existing units are covered under the scheme.

Eligibility Criteria:

- **Eligible Sectors under this Scheme:**
- The scheme offers assistance for the following sectors:
- Fruits & vegetable processing
- Milk Processing
- Meat/poultry/fish processing
- Ready to Eat/Ready to Cook Food Products Breakfast cereals Snacks bakery and other food products including nutritional health foods Grains pulses, oil seed milling and processing based on modern technology.
- Modern Rice milling.
- Other agri-horti products including spices, coconut, soybean, mushroom processing, honey processing, etc.
- Fruits/Honey-based wines.
- Natural Food flavors, food additives food extracts & colors, oleoresins, guar gum, cocoa products, etc.
- Manufacturing jaggery from sugarcane and value-added products from jaggery (as raw material).
- Any other sector that makes food products fit for human consumption.
- Animal feed manufacturing unit to be set up in Mega Food Parks and Agro Processing Clusters approved by the Ministry from time to time.
- Carbonated Drinks and beverages containing fruit juice.

Benefits:

- The scheme envisages financial assistance to food processing units in the form of grant-in-aid (maximum Rs. 5 crore) as under:
- 35% of the eligible project cost in General Areas
- 50% of the eligible project cost in the NE States, hilly areas, State Notified Integrated Tribal Development Project (ITDP) areas
- 50% of the eligible project cost for projects promoted by SC ST entrepreneurs.

Benefit Tags: Cash Benefit Schemes

Tenure: Active

Notes:

- 50% of the eligible project cost for projects promoted by SC ST entrepreneurs.

Apply: https://blog.forumias.com/creation-expansion-of-food-processing-preservation-capacities-cefppc-scheme/#:~:text=It%20is%20a%20sub-scheme%20of%20Pradhan%20Mantri%20Kisan,level%20of%20processing%2C%20value%20addition%20and%20reduce%20wastage.

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35. PM FME Scheme

Ministry: Ministry of Food Processing Industries

Sectors: Food Processing Sector

Brief: PM FME Scheme (PM Formalization of Micro Food Processing Enterprises Scheme) is a government initiative aimed at supporting and formalizing micro food processing enterprises. This scheme provides various benefits and resources to promote entrepreneurship and growth in the food processing sector.

Eligibility Criteria:

- The company should be an existing Micro Food Processing Unit.
- The company should not be corporate and would be having less than 10 workers.

- The company should follow the policy of One District One Product (ODOP) then they will be given preference but other companies would also be considered.
- The applicant should have the ownership right of the company.
- The company or enterprise could be a Proprietary or Partner Firm.
- The maximum age of the applicant to apply for the scheme should be 18 years old.
- The applicant applying should be at least class 8th passed.
- This scheme has been eligible for only one person from a single family.
- The applicant should be willing to pay at least 10 percent of the amount and the rest of the amount will be given as a bank loan.
- The cost of the land on which the enterprise has been set would not be considered in the total cost of the project.
- The rent of the building cost, lease cost, or the rental cost could be included in the total cost of the project.
- The lease cost that would included in the project cost would not be more than 3 years of lease.

Benefits:

- Food processing entrepreneurs through credit-linked capital subsidy @35% of the eligible project cost with a maximum ceiling of Rs.10 lakh per unit.
- Seed capital @ Rs. 40,000 - per SHG member for working capital and purchase of small tools.
- Credit linked grant of 35% for capital investment to FPOs SHGs producer cooperatives.
- Support for marketing & branding to micro-units.
- Support for common infrastructure and handholding support to SHGs, FPOs and Producer Cooperatives.
- Providing Capacity building and training support to increase the capabilities of the enterprises and upgradation of skills of workers.

Benefit Tags: Cash Benefit Schemes

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- Rs. 10,000 crore over a period of five years from 2020-21 to 2024-25.

Tenure: 2020-21 to 2024-25.

Notes:

- Ministry of Food Processing Industries (MoFPI), in partnership with the State UT Governments, has launched an all India Centrally Sponsored PM Formalisation of Micro food processing Enterprises Scheme (PM FME Scheme) for providing financial, technical and business support for upgradation of existing micro food processing enterprises.

Apply: https://pmfme.mofpi.gov.in/pmfme/newsletters/

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36. PLI Scheme for Automobile and Auto components

Ministry: Ministry of Heavy Industries & Public Enterprises

Sectors: Automobile

Brief: The government has introduced the Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme for Automobile and Auto Components Industry for Enhancing India's Manufacturing Capabilities for Advanced Automotive Products. This scheme proposes financial incentives to boost domestic manufacturing of Advanced Automotive Technology products and attract investments in the automotive manufacturing value chain.

Eligibility Criteria:

- For detailed information regarding eligibility, please refer to the guidelines document from the link below: https://www.indiafilings.com/learn/pli-scheme-for-automobile-and-auto-component-industry/#:~:text=Eligibility%20Criteria%20for%20Existing%20Company&text=Minimum%20Rs.,10%2C000%20crores.&text=Global%20Investment%20of%20Company%20

Benefits:

- The PLI scheme for the auto sector will incentivize high-value Advanced Automotive Technology vehicles and products.
- The PLI Scheme for the auto sector envisages overcoming the cost disabilities to the industry for manufacturing of Advanced Automotive Technology products in India.
- The incentive structure will encourage the industry to make fresh investments in indigenous supply chain deep localization of Advanced Automotive Technology products.

Benefit Tags: Cash Benefit Schemes

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- Rupees 25,938 crore for a period of 5 years (FY2022-23 to FY2026-27)

Tenure: FY2022-23 to FY2026-27

Apply: https://heavyindustries.gov.in

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37. PLI Scheme for National Programme on Advanced Chemistry Cell (ACC) Battery Storage

Ministry: Ministry of Heavy Industries & Public Enterprises

Sectors: Energy Storage Sector

Brief: The Ministry of Heavy Industries & Public Enterprises presents the PLI Scheme for National Programme on Advanced Chemistry Cell (ACC) Battery Storage. This scheme is designed to boost the production of advanced chemistry cell (ACC) batteries in India and promote the adoption of clean and efficient energy storage solutions.

Benefits:

- Facilitate demand creation for battery storage in India.
- Facilitate Make-in-India and Atmanirbhar Bharat, thereby emphasizing domestic value capture and reduction in import dependence.
- Facilitate demand for EVs, which are proven to be significantly less polluting. One of the key agendas for ACC battery storage will be to reduce India's Greenhouse Gas (GHG) emissions.
- Import substitution of around INR 200 billion – INR 250 billion (US$2.76 – US$3.45 billion) every year, on account of oil imports as this scheme is expected to accelerate EV adoption in India.
- Impetus to research and development to achieve higher specific energy density and cycles in ACC.
- Promote newer and niche cell technologies.

Benefit Tags: Facilitation Benefit

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- Budgetary outlay of Rupees 18,100 crores

Tenure: The scheme has an initial 2 (two) years of Gestation Period from the Appointed Date (AD) (01.01.2023 to 31.12.2024) and Five Years post gestation period (01.01.2025 to 31.12.2029) is the Performance period.

Apply: https://heavyindustries.gov.in

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38. National Urban Livelihoods Mission

Ministry: Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs Schemes

Sectors: Employment

Brief: The scheme aims to reduce poverty and vulnerability of the urban poor households by enabling them to access gainful self-employment and skilled wage employment opportunities, resulting in an appreciable improvement in their livelihoods on a sustainable basis, through building strong grassroots level institutions of the poor.

Benefits:

- Employment through Skill Training and placement
- ESTP Self Employment Programme
- SEP Social Mobilization and Institutional Development
- SMID Shelter for Urban Homeless
- SUH Support to Urban Street vendor
- SUSV Capacity Building and Training Programmes – CBT.

Apply: https://nulm.gov.in/

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39. Employment Linked Incentive (ELI) Scheme

Ministry: Ministry of Labour & Employment, Government of India

Sectors: All sectors, with a special focus on the manufacturing sector.

Brief: PM-VBRY is an employment-linked incentive scheme (previously referred to as the ELI Scheme) approved by the Union Cabinet. It aims to generate over 3.5 crore jobs in India over a two-year period (from 1 August 2025 to 31 July 2027). The scheme provides incentives for both first-time employees (to ease their entry into formal employment) and employers (to encourage new job creation). It is implemented by EPFO under the Ministry of Labour & Employment.

Benefits:

- Part A (for First-Time Employees): Eligible if salary ≤ ₹1,00,000 per month. Up to ₹15,000 incentive in two instalments. First instalment after 6 months of employment; second instalment after 12 months plus completion of a financial literacy programme. Some portion of the incentive will be kept in a savings instrument / deposit account for a fixed period; withdrawable later.
- Part B (for Employers): For each additional employee hired (salary ≤ ₹1,00,000/month) with sustained employment of at least 6 months. Employers get up to ₹3,000 per month per new employee for two years. In the manufacturing sector, the incentives may extend into the 3rd and 4th year for sustained employment. Establishments must hire at least:
- 2 additional employees (if they have < 50 employees) or
- 5 additional employees (if they have ≥ 50 employees) and sustain for at least 6 months.

Other Benefits / Features: Formalization of jobs including social security benefits. On job training and enhanced employability for first-timers. Use of Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT), Aadhaar Bridge Payment System (ABPS), PAN-linked accounts for benefit disbursal.

Benefit Tags: Employment generation, Social security / Formalization of jobs, Financial assistance / Incentives (for both employee & employer), Skill / financial literacy component, Focus on first timers (new entrants to workforce)

Tenure: From 1 August 2025 to 31 July 2027 (2 years) during which jobs created will qualify for benefits.

Apply: https://pmvbry.labour.gov.in/

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40. Aspire - A Scheme for Promotion of Innovation, Rural Industries and Entrepreneurship

Ministry: Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises

Sectors: Innovation, Rural Industries & Entrepreneurship

Brief: ASPIRE- was launched to set up a network of technology centers and to set up incubation centers to accelerate entrepreneurship and to promote start-ups for innovation in the agriculture industry with the following objectives:

Eligibility Criteria:

- Any agency/institution of Government of India, State government or existing training centers under Ministries/Departments of Government of India/State Government, Industry Associations, Academic Institutions.
- Any not-for-profit private institutions with experience in successfully executing incubation and/or skill development programs may be eligible to set up an LBI.

Apply: https://aspire.msme.gov.in/ASPIRE/AFHome.aspx

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41. Entrepreneurship Skill Development Programme(ESDP)Scheme

Ministry: Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises

Brief: The objective of the program is to motivate youth representing different sections of the society including SC ST Women, differently abled, Ex-servicemen and BPL persons to consider self-employment or entrepreneurship as one of the career options. The ultimate objective is to promote new enterprises, capacity building of existing MSMEs and inculcating entrepreneurial culture in the country.

Eligibility Criteria:

- The scheme is applicable for all aspiring and existing entrepreneurs.

Benefits:

- The scheme aims to expand the base of entrepreneurship to different sections of the society through skill development, achievement, and providing motivation for self-employment and entrepreneurial skill.

Benefit Tags: Skill Development

Tenure: Active

Notes:

- To promote new enterprises, capacity building of existing MSMEs and inculcating entrepreneurial culture in the country.

Apply: https://msmedi.dcmsme.gov.in/

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42. Raw Material Assistance Scheme

Ministry: Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises

Department: NSIC

Sectors: Raw Material

Brief: Raw Material Assistance Scheme aims at helping MSMEs by way of financing the purchase of Raw Materials (Both indigenous & imported). This gives an opportunity to MSMEs to focus better on manufacturing quality products.

Eligibility Criteria:

- The Entrepreneurs are required to apply for Raw Material Assistance only on the prescribed application forms. The application forms downloaded from the link given below may be filled and can be submitted to the nearest Branch Office. The blank forms are also available free of charge from the Branch offices.

Benefits:

- Facilitating procurement of Raw Material with credit support up to 180 days
- SMEs helped to avail Economics of Purchases like bulk purchase, cash discount etc.

Apply: https://www.nsic.co.in/schemes/Raw-Material-Against-BG

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43. Trade Related Entrepreneurship Assistance and Development (TREAD) Scheme for Women

Ministry: Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises

Sectors: Trade

Benefit Tags: Credit Benefit

Notes:

- This scheme envisages economic empowerment of women by providing credit (through NGOs), training, development and counseling extension activities related to trades, products, services, etc.

Apply: https://www.msmediagra.gov.in/womentread.htm

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44. Development of Solar Parks and Ultra Mega Solar Power Projects

Ministry: Ministry of New and Renewable Energy Sources Schemes

Sectors: Energy

Brief: Solar power projects can be set up anywhere in the country, however, the solar power projects developed in a scattered manner lead to higher project cost per MW and higher transmission losses. Individual projects of smaller capacity incur significant expenses in site development, drawing separate transmission lines to the nearest substation, procuring water, and creating other necessary infrastructure. It also takes longer for project developers to acquire land, get all types of clearances and permissions, etc. which ultimately delays the project. To overcome these challenges, the scheme for “Development of Solar Parks and Ultra-Mega Solar Power Projects” was rolled out in December 2014 with an objective to facilitate the solar project developers to set up projects expeditiously.

Eligibility Criteria:

- For detailed information regarding eligibility criteria, please refer to the guidelines document from the link below: (<a href='https://mnre.gov.in/development-of-solar-parks-and-ultra-mega-solar-power-projects/', target='_blank'>https://mnre.gov.in/development-of-solar-parks-and-ultra-mega-solar-power-projects/)

Benefits:

- Under the scheme, the Ministry provides Central Financial Assistance (CFA) of up to Rs. 25 lakh per solar park for preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR). Besides this, CFA of up to Rs. 20.00 lakh per MW or 30% of the project cost, including Grid-connectivity cost, whichever is lower, is also provided on achieving the milestones prescribed in the scheme.

Benefit Tags: Funding

Tenure: Up to 2025-26

Notes:

- To overcome these challenges, the scheme for “Development of Solar Parks and Ultra-Mega Solar Power Projects” was rolled out in December 2014 with an objective to facilitate the solar project developers to set up projects expeditiously.

Apply: https://mnre.gov.in/development-of-solar-parks-and-ultra-mega-solar-power-projects/

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45. Promoting Innovations in Individuals, Startups and MSMEs (PRISM)

Ministry: Ministry of Science & Technology

Department: Department of Scientific and Industrial Research

Sectors: Science and Technology

Brief: The scheme provides grants, technical guidance, and mentoring to individual innovators by incubating their ideas towards the creation of new enterprises in phases. It also provides grant-in-aid support to technology solution providers developing technology solutions aimed at helping MSME clusters. The scheme runs in two phases.

Eligibility Criteria:

- The scheme runs in two phases.
- For PRISM I, any Indian citizen including student innovators can apply.
- For PRISM II, PRISM innovators or innovators who have successfully demonstrated proof of concept with the support of government institution/agency, PRISM-R&D proposals and public-funded – R&D institutes/autonomous institutions/laboratories/academic institutes, etc. are eligible.

Benefits:

- PRISM Phase-I Category-I: For proof of concept/prototype/models, with a project cost up to INR 5 Lakhs, a maximum of INR 2 Lakhs or 90% of the total project cost (whichever is less) is provided.
- PRISM Phase-I, Category-II: For fabrication of a working model/process know-how/testing & trial/patenting/technology transfer, etc. with a project costing between INR 5 Lakhs to INR 35 Lakhs, a maximum of INR 20 Lakhs or 90% of the total project cost (whichever is less) is given.
- Prism-Phase-II: Enterprise incubation, with a project costing between INR 35 Lakhs and INR 100 Lakhs, up to INR 50 Lakh limited to 50% of the total project cost is provided. For PRISM-R&D Proposals, up to INR 50 Lakhs limited to 50% of the total project cost is given.

Apply: https://www.indiascienceandtechnology.gov.in/funding-opportunities/startups/promoting-innovations-individuals-startups-and-msmes-prism

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46. Biotechnology ignition grant (big)

Ministry: Ministry of Science & Technology

Department: Department of Biotechnology (DBT)

Sectors: Biotechnology

Brief: The basic idea of SEED Fund is providing Capital assistance to startups with new and meritorious ideas, innovations and technologies. This would enable some of these start-ups to graduate to a level where they will be able to raise investments from angel/Venture capitalist or they will reach a position to seek loans from commercial banks /financial institutions. Thus the proposed seed support is positioned to act as a bridge between promoters investment and Venture/Angel investment. This is not an investment scheme, but, rather a support scheme to enable start-ups and incubator to attain sustainability.

Eligibility Criteria:

- **Individual:**
- The individual applicant should be an Indian citizen
- The primary applicant should be the Project Leader
- The applicant has to be incubated in an incubator (Incubator could be located anywhere in the country and may/may not be supported by BIRAC). At the time of application, the applicant is expected to have identified preferred incubator. LoI/MoU with the incubator is required for final approval.
- Employed individuals
-
    - Individual who is a promoter shareholder of a Biotech company or one of the partners in a Biotech LLP will not be allowed to apply as an individual, irrespective of the percentage of shareholding of the applicant in the company.
- **Startups/Companies:**
- The Company/LLP should be registered under the Indian Companies Act, 1956/2013
- The incorporation date of the Company/LLP should not be earlier than 5 years from the date of closing of a particular BIG call.
- A company is considered as 'owned' by resident Indian citizen(s) if minimum 51% of the capital is beneficially owned by resident Indian citizen(s) and / or Indian companies, which are ultimately owned and controlled by resident Indian citizens
- Company/LLP's application should be represented by a Project Leader
- The Company/LLP must have its own in-house R&D facility that is functional and adequate to execute the project. If the Company/LLP does not have a functional and adequate laboratory of its own then it should be incubated at an incubator
- If an applicant company, in which any promoter holding more than or equal to 20% of the shares, is a co-promoter of another ineligible company or a partner in another ineligible LLP, then the applicant will not be eligible. The only exception to this shall be situation wherein the latter ineligible company/LLP is operating in non-biotech domain. In case applicant is a LLP: An applicant LLP, in which any of the partners is also a partner in another ineligible LLP or is a co-promoter in another ineligible company, then the applicant will not be eligible. The only exception to this shall be situation wherein the latter ineligible LLP/company is operating in non-biotech domain.

Benefits:

- It offers numerous benefits for both incubators and the startups they support. For incubators, it strengthens their capacity to nurture early-stage biotechnology ventures by providing financial resources for seed funding and attracting promising startups. This enhances their track record of successful portfolio companies and strengthens their position within the ecosystem. For startups, the SEED Fund alleviates the financial burden of early-stage development, enabling them to focus on critical activities like proof-of-concept demonstrations and initial market validation. Access to expertise and guidance from established incubators further accelerates their growth and increases their chances of success in the competitive biotechnology landscape.

Benefit Tags: Incubators

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- The funding support under BIG is in the form of grantin-aid. Extent of funding is up to INR 50 lakhs.

Tenure: Active

Apply: https://birac.nic.in/seedFund.php

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47. DST National Mission on Interdisciplinary Cyber-Physical Systems (DST NM-ICPS)

Ministry: Ministry of Science & Technology

Department: Department of Science and Technology

Sectors: Technology

Brief: The National Mission on Interdisciplinary Cyber-Physical Systems (NM-ICPS) is transforming ideas, concepts, and prototypes into market-ready products and boosting new and emerging technologies to power national initiatives in key areas. The 25 Technology Innovation Hubs (TIH) set up across the country under the mission are bringing about the transformation by actively coordinating, communicating, and facilitating technology transfer to industries.

Eligibility Criteria:

- **Researchers and faculty :** Ph.D. degree in Science, Engineering, or related fields Experience in research and development related to Cyber-Physical Systems (CPS) Affiliation with a recognized academic or research institution in India Strong publication record in relevant fields.
- **Students :** Master's degree in Science, Engineering, or related fields Good academic record with a strong interest in CPS research Enrollment in a Ph.D. program at a recognized Indian institution.
- **Start-ups and entrepreneurs :** Focus on developing innovative CPS solutions with potential for commercialization Strong team with relevant expertise in technology, business, and marketing Incorporation as a registered company in India.
- **Industry partners :** Commitment to collaborate with academic institutions and research labs Interest in adopting and deploying CPS technologies for their products and services Willingness to invest in R&D and innovation activities.

Benefits:

- Benefits of the DST National Mission on Interdisciplinary Cyber-Physical Systems (DST NM-ICPS).
- For Researchers and faculty : Funding for research projects Access to research infrastructure and facilities.

- For Students : Scholarships and fellowships Internship and research opportunities.
- For Start-ups and entrepreneurs : Seed funding and incubation support Access to market and expertise
- For Industry partners : Early access to cutting-edge technologies Reduced R&D costs.

Benefit Tags: funding

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- The financial support for each TIH under NM-ICPS would be about Rs 115 crore in a project mode for a period of five years.

Tenure: Active

Apply: https://dst.gov.in/nm-icps-boosting-new-and-emerging-technologies-power-national-initiatives#:~:text=The%20National%20Mission%20on%20Interdisciplinary,national%20initiatives%20in%20key%20areas.

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48. DST Water Technology Call for Proposals 2023

Ministry: Ministry of Science & Technology

Department: Department of Science & Technology (DST), Govt of India

Sectors: Water/Environment

Brief: The primary aim of this call is to stimulate research proposals that strongly emphasize solution-oriented scientific work. Proposals should establish a clear connection between the need for scientific research, gaps in existing knowledge, and the demand for project deliverables. The current DST-WTC Call focuses on supporting research in specific themes related to water. These efforts align with the objectives of achieving Sustainable Development Goal #6. Additionally, they complement the missions and programs of other relevant ministries, such as National Water Missions, Jal Jeevan Mission, National Amrit Sarovar Mission, Atal Bhujal Yojana, Har Ghar Nal Scheme, River Development and Ganga Rejuvenation, and Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana (PMKSY).

Eligibility Criteria:

- Eligibility as per the official scheme document: For the Applied Research Stream (Leading to the establishment of Proof-of-Concept), the proposals are to be led by faculties/ scientists working in a regular position in recognized Academic Organisation /Public funded R&D Institutions/ Laboratories, Central and State government autonomous organizations State S & T councils.
- For the technology Development Stream (Leading to Lab Scale Demonstration), the proposals have to be submitted in the Institute – Industry / User partnership mode only. The proposals are to be led by faculties/ scientists working in regular positions in recognized Academic Institutions, Public funded R&D Institutions/ Laboratories, State S&T councils in partnership with other academic/ R&D organisations, state-line departments, S&T-based voluntary organisations, DSIR-recognized SIRO organization, etc. The company/industry should be willing to contribute in the form of industry-attributable technical inputs and resources with at least 10% of the project cost in cash.
- For the Technology Assessment Stream (Leading to Pilot-Scale demonstration of the technology in the field setting), the proposals are to be led by faculties/ scientists working in a regular position in recognized Academic institutions, Public-funded R&D Institutions/ Laboratories in partnership with other academic, R&D organizations, DSIR-recognized R&D organizations, industries, and Users (Utility, Panchayat, Municipal Corporation, Urban Development Authority, etc).
- For the Convergent Solution Stream, the proposals have to be submitted in consortium mode only. The consortium is expected to be led by faculties/ scientists working in a regular position in recognized academic institutions, public-funded R&D Institutions/ Laboratories, state S&T councils in partnership with other academic/ R&D organisations, state line departments, S&T-based voluntary organizations, etc. Participation of industries/ start-ups is also welcome, wherever applicable. The consortium should essentially include at least a user having an interest in the intervention, a solution designer, and a solution provider.

Benefits:

- DST-WTC Call would support thematic R&D on issues related to Water Availability, Water Distribution, Water Quality Analysis Treatment, Industrial wastewater recycling, Reuse, and Management, etc

Benefit Tags: Research Funding

Tenure: August 7, 2023, to Saturday, September 30, 2023, subject to extension

Notes:

- The objective of the call is to mobilize development and applications research proposals having strong solution science orientation. The need for scientific work, the gap in existing knowledge, and the demand for deliverables emanating from the project should be firmly established in the proposal. The present DST-WTC Call would support thematic R&D on issues related to Water Availability, Water Distribution, Water Quality Analysis Treatment, Industrial wastewater recycling, Reuse, and Management, etc. and may help in achieving targets of Sustainable Development Goals (SDG#6)along with the other in-line Ministries Missions Programmes on water such as National Water Missions, Jal Jeevan Mission, National Amrit Sarovar Mission, Atul Bhujal Yojana, Har Ghar Nal Scheme, River Development and Ganga Rejuvenation, Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana (PMKSY), etc.

Apply: https://onlinedst.gov.in/Projectproposalformat.aspx

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49. E-YUVA

Ministry: Ministry of Science & Technology

Department: DBT - BIRAC

Sectors: Biotechnology

Brief: E-YUVA scheme is mandated to promote a culture of applied research and need-oriented (societal or industry) entrepreneurial innovation among young students and researchers. The scheme provides funding support (through fellowship and research grant), technical and business mentoring, exposure to bio incubation model, orientation to entrepreneurial culture, etc. to students at various levels including undergraduates, post-graduates, and post-doctoral.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Open to students pursuing postgraduate studies (Masters or PhD) in biotechnology or related fields from recognized Indian universities and institutes.
- Faculty members and researchers from Indian academic institutions can also apply as mentors for student teams.
- Projects should focus on translational research with potential for societal or industrial applications.
- Applicants must demonstrate innovation and feasibility of their proposed research.

Benefits:

- This BIRAC's scheme is implemented through dedicated hubs called E-YUVA Centers (EYCs) housed within the University Institute set up and mentored by a BIRAC BioNEST supported bio-incubator. EYCs act as anchors and extend requisite support and mentoring to students. Each EYC has a BIRAC-supported pre-incubation space which offers infrastructure and equipment for basic research and experimentation by selected students. Advanced research needs are fulfilled through bio-incubator connect.

Benefit Tags: funding

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- **Benefits to Applicants :**
- Financial Support: Up to Rs. 50 lakhs per project for a period of two years.
- Mentorship and Training: Guidance from experienced researchers and industry experts.
- Access to Research Infrastructure: Facilities and resources at BIRAC partner institutions.
- Networking and Collaboration: Opportunities to connect with other researchers and potential investors.
- Recognition and Visibility: Showcase their research at national and international events.

Tenure: Active

Apply: https://www.birac.nic.in/desc_new.php?id=262

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50. High Risk-High Reward Research

Ministry: Ministry of Science & Technology

Department: Department of Science & Technology

Sectors: Technology

Brief: The High Risk - High Reward Research aims at supporting proposals that are conceptually novel and risky, and if successful, are expected to cause a paradigm shifting influence on the S&T. The applicant (s) must be an Indian citizen residing in India and must hold a regular academic research position in a recognized institution. The proposals can be submitted by an individual or by a team of investigators. Proposals submitted by a team of investigators must identify a Principal Investigator who will spearhead the research objectives and administer the grant. The focus of proposals should be on formulating novel hypotheses or scientific breakthroughs which aid in the emergence of new technologies.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Applicant should be an Indian citizen residing in India. The applicant(s) must hold a regular academic research position in a recognized institution. The proposals can be submitted by an individual or by a team of investigators. Proposals submitted by a team of investigators must identify a Principal Investigator, who will spearhead the research objectives and administer the grant.

Benefits:

- The funding is provided normally for a period of three years. In exceptional cases, the duration can be up to 5 years as assessed by the expert committee.
- No budget limit is prescribed for this type of projects. The research grant covers equipment, consumables, contingency and travel apart from overhead grants.

Benefit Tags: Facilitation Support

Tenure: Active

Apply: https://serbonline.in/SERB/HRR

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51. NIDHI Programme

Ministry: Ministry of Science & Technology

Department: Department of Science & Technology (DST), Govt of India

Brief: National Initiative for Developing and Harnessing Innovations (NIDHI) is an umbrella program conceived and developed by the Innovation & Entrepreneurship division, Department of Science & Technology, Government of India, for nurturing ideas and innovations (knowledge-based and technology-driven) into successful startups. The program would work in line with the national priorities and goals and its focus would be to build an innovation-driven entrepreneurial ecosystem with an objective of socioeconomic development through wealth and job creation. NIDHI aims to nurture start-ups through scouting, supporting, and scaling innovations. The key components of NIDHI are –

Eligibility Criteria:

- All the NIDHI-Startup Funds will be disbursed to eligible startups only through eligible NSTEDB linked incubators across India
- For more detailed information:https://www.nstedb.com

Benefits:

- Guidance from experienced, innovative and highly successful entrepreneurs on the business concept, strategy or venture, and insight into specific industries or markets.
- Best practices for starting a business and broadening the professional network.
- Co-working spaces for developing the idea into a marketable product.

Benefit Tags: Funding

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- Avg. Seed Fund Amount for Startups is Rs. 25 Lakhs which goes Upto 100 Lakhs per startup

Tenure: Active

Notes:

- The basic idea of seed support is to provide financial assistance to the incubators registered as not-for Profit entities approved or funded by the Department of Science and Technology (DST) or any other central or state government to support potential startups with promising ideas, innovations, and technologies. The key objective of the NIDHI- SEED SUPPORT (SS) PROGRAM is to ensure the timely availability of seed support through incubators to deserving startups within an incubator, thereby enabling them to take their venture to the next level and facilitate their success in the marketplace. The scheme also enables the incubators to widen their pipeline of startups and also share the success of their startups which would also result in ensuring their long-term operational sustainability.

Apply: https://dst.gov.in/callforproposals/ssp-call-proposals-under-nidhi-programme

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52. NewGen Innovation and Entrepreneurship Development Centre

Ministry: Ministry of Science & Technology

Sectors: Science and Technology

Brief: New Generation Innovation and Entrepreneurship Development Centre (NewGen IEDC) is the program launched by the National Science and Technology Entrepreneurship Development Board (NSTEDB), Department of Science & Technology (DST), Government of India, and implemented by EDII, Ahmedabad. NewGen IEDC aims to inculcate the spirit of innovation and entrepreneurship amongst the young S&T students and encourage and support start-up creation through guidance, mentorship & support. NewGen IEDCs would be established in academic institutions where students will be encouraged to take up innovative projects with the possibility of commercialization.

Eligibility Criteria:

- The institution should be a University/Deemed University or a premier Institute/College offering Engineering, Technology, Science courses at the degree level or above for at least 5 years.
- The institution must have at least two faculty members trained in Entrepreneurship through DST sponsored Faculty Development Programme and should have a minimum dedicated space of about 5000 square feet for housing the NewGen IEDC.

Benefits:

- Upto Rs. 25 Lakhs and recurring expenditure (Project Development Cost, Travel, Training and Contingencies, etc.) of up to Rs. 10 lakhs for five full operational years is provided.

Apply: https://www.indiascienceandtechnology.gov.in/funding-opportunities/startups/newgen-innovation-and-entrepreneurship-development-centre-newgen-iedc

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53. Small Business Innovation Research Initiative (SBIRI)

Ministry: Ministry of Science & Technology

Department: Department of Biotechnology (DBT)

Sectors: Biotechnology

Brief: The Small Business Innovation Research Initiative (SBIRI) scheme of the Department of Biotechnology, Ministry of Science & Technology was launched in 2005 to boost Public-Private- Partnership (PPP) efforts in the country. SBIRI was the first of its kind, early-stage, innovation-focused PPP initiative in the area of Biotechnology. The launching of SBIRI has worked as an enabling platform for the target organizations to realize their potential in terms of product and process development and taking them to the market. It has facilitated innovation, and risk-taking by small and medium companies and brought together the private industry, public institutions, and the government under one roof to promote the research and innovation in the Indian Biotech Sector. The projects supported under the scheme have resulted in prominent outcomes in the form of some products which have already come to the market and some promising research leads seeing a ray of hope for commercialization.

Eligibility Criteria:

- **The proposals can be submitted**
- Solely by a Company incorporated under the Companies Act, 2013 or Limited Liability Partnership (LLP) incorporated under the Limited Liability Partnership Act, 2008 or Joint Ventures either in the form of Company/ LLP by any of the above entities jointly with other private or public partners (s) (Universities or Institutes).
- **ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA FOR INDUSTRY**
- Minimum 51% of the shares of the Company should be held by Indian Citizens holding Indian passports (Indian Citizens do not include Person of Indian Origin (PIO) and Overseas Citizenship of India (OCI) holders) Minimum half of the persons who subscribed their names to the LLP document as its Partners should be Indian citizens. Participating companies should have adequate in-house facilities to address the project implementation aspects (which shall be evaluated during the site visit) OR Incubated with any of the recognized Incubation Facility.
- **ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA FOR ACADEMIC COLLABORATOR**
- Public/private university/colleges in India
- National research laboratories
- Not-for-profit private research labs/societies/foundation

Benefits:

- Grant Funding
- Additional Funding Opportunities
- Technical and Business Support
- Mentorship and Guidance
- Access to Infrastructure and Facilities
- Networking Opportunities
- Publicity and Recognition

Benefit Tags: Infrastructure

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- SBIRI provides grant funding to selected projects, typically ranging from Rs. 25 lakh to Rs. 50 lakh, depending on the project scope and duration. This funding alleviates the financial burden of early-stage R&D, allowing businesses to focus on development and proof-of-concept demonstrations.

Tenure: Active

Apply: https://birac.nic.in/desc_new.php?id=217

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54. Technology Development Programme

Ministry: Ministry of Science & Technology

Department: Department of Science and Technology

Sectors: Science and Technology

Brief: The primary objective of the Programme is to facilitate and support development of products or techniques/technology aimed at specific end use. The specific objectives of the Programme are to develop and integrate technologies following a holistic approach in identified areas;promote application of modern/advanced technologies to socio-economic problem solving;promote modernization of traditional technologies, tools and skills;facilitate enhancing quality and performance of the traditional/non-traditional items;encourage developments in application of R&D activities; andpromote activities aimed at improving technology, technique, material, methods and other appropriate activities conducive for development of technology status in identified areas.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Project Proposals can be submitted for financial support by scientists/engineers/technologists working in academic institutions/registered societies/R&D institutions/laboratories having adequate infrastructure/facilities to carry out technology development work. The Programme encourages multi-disciplinary Proposals envisaging network/collaboration of various Organizations having diverse expertise and facilities for synergistic implementation of the Projects. Participation of industry is encouraged.
- Project Proposals from academic/R&D Institutions in collaboration with Industry having DSIR recognized R&D Laboratories will be preferred.

Apply: https://dst.gov.in/technology-development-program-tdp

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55. Technology Incubation and Development of Entrepreneurs (TIDE) 2.0

Ministry: Ministry of Science & Technology

Department: Department of Science & Technology (DST), Govt of India

Sectors: Technology

Brief: TIDE 2.0 will promote tech entrepreneurship through financial and technical support to incubators engaged in supporting ICT startups primarily engaged in using emerging technologies such as IoT, AI, Blockchain, Robotics, etc. in pre-identified areas of societal relevance. The Scheme will be implemented through empowering 51 incubators in India and handholding close to 2000 tech start-ups over a period of 5 years. The scheme envisions creating a holistic ecosystem to support technology startups and incubation centers through identifying and creating necessary linkages.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Organisation of higher learning and R&D organizations across India, having incubation facilities and established links with large companies, industry bodies, and industry clusters are eligible for the scheme.

Benefits:

- Co-Working and Infrastructure Facilities (Labs)
- Workshop Facilities and Utilities
- Funding and Further Opportunities for Investment
- Technical and Business Mentoring
- Business Support and Networking.

Benefit Tags: Funding

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- Overall outlay of Rs 264 crore over a period of five years.

Notes:

- TIDE 2.0 will promote tech entrepreneurship through financial and technical support to incubators engaged in supporting ICT startups primarily engaged in using emerging technologies such as IoT, AI, Blockchain, Robotics, etc. in pre-identified areas of societal relevance. The Scheme will be implemented through empowering 51 incubators in India and handholding close to 2000 tech start-ups over a period of 5 years. The scheme envisions creating a holistic ecosystem to support technology startups and incubation centers through identifying and creating necessary linkages.

Apply: https://www.indiascienceandtechnology.gov.in/funding-opportunities/startups/technology-incubation-and-development-entrepreneurs-tide-20

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56. Ambedkar Social Innovation Incubation Mission (ASIIM) Scheme under VCF-SC

Ministry: Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment (MoSJE)

Department: Department of Social Justice and Empowerment

Sectors: Scheduled Castes

Brief: In order to boost entrepreneurship and innovation among the SC students/ SC Divyang youth, MoS&JE has launched an initiative viz. "Ambedkar Social Innovation and Incubation Mission (ASIIM)" under VCF-SC on 30th September 2020.

Eligibility Criteria:

- **The eligibility criteria for sending proposals for seeking assistance under ASIIM initiative is as follows:**
- Youth who have been identified by the TBIs. Atal Incubation Centers (AICs), Technology / Industrial Parks, Science and Technology Parks of India (STPI) being promoted by Department of Science & Technology (DST) or other than DST and other incubation centers supported by Government of
- Youth who are identified for incubation by reputed private TBIs.
- Students who have been awarded under the Smart India Hackathon or Smart India Hardware Hackathon being conducted by Ministry of Education.
- Innovative ideas focusing on the socio-economic development of the society identified in the TBIs in public, private sector.
- Start-ups nominated and supported by corporates through CSR funds.

Benefits:

- The identified innovative ideas from SC students in the TBIs would be provided equity assistance towards TBI accommodation cost, Hardware, Software, Fellowship, Travel and marketing, IP filing, Tool-room expenses, Co-workers etc.
- During the incubation period of 3 years, the entrepreneurs shall not be insisted for any financial contribution except the expenses required for forming a company which would be borne by the entrepreneurs or TBIs. Financial assistance to these initiatives shall be released to the Companies promoted by these young SC entrepreneurs.
- Funding of up to Rs.30 lakhs over a three-year period as equity.
- Coupon - 4% p.a. (3.75% for women/ Divyang SC entrepreneurs)
- Investment Period in Company – Up to 10 years including moratorium upto 36 months.

Benefit Tags: Funding

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- Under ASIIM initiative, 1,000 SC youth would be identified in the next 4 years with start-up ideas through the Technology Business Incubators (TBIs) in various higher educational institutions. They will be funded @ Rs. 30 lakhs in 3 years as equity funding so that they can translate their start-up ideas into commercial ventures. Successful ventures would further qualify for venture funding of up to Rs.15 Cr from the Venture Capital Fund for Scheduled Castes.

Apply: https://www.vcfsc.in/asiim/index.html

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57. SENIOR CARE AGEING GROWTH ENGINE (SAGE) VENTURE FUND

Ministry: Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment (MoSJE)

Department: Department of Social Justice and Empowerment

Sectors: Elderly care sector

Brief: A Fund targeted to provide equity support up to Rs.1 Crore for up to 49% stake in such start-ups which innovate on products and services for Senior Citizens of India.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Innovative ideas awarded in the National level innovation challenges such as Smart India Hackathons (of M/o Education) or such other innovative drives – proposing to set up companies and offer products and services for the welfare of the elderly in India.

- Start-ups already functioning in the elderly segment in India proposing to expand operations.All the startups fulfilling the startup norms as per guidelines by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), Ministry of Commerce, Govt. of India are eligible for applying.

- Being incorporated or registered in India for less than ten years from its date of incorporation.
- Annual turnover not exceeding Rs 25 crores in any of the preceding financial years.
- Incorporated as a Company (Private / Public)
- Aims to work towards innovation, development, deployment or commercialization of new products, Solutions, processes or services driven by technology or intellectual property in the realm of elder care.
- It is not formed by splitting up or reconstructing a business already in existence.

Benefits:

- Equity support upto Rs.1 Crore

Benefit Tags: Funding

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- Equity support upto Rs.1 Crore

Tenure: Active

Apply: https://www.ifciventure.com/sage-venture-funds/Investment-Process.html

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58. Venture Capital Fund for Backward Classes (VCF-BC)

Ministry: Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment (MoSJE)

Department: Department of Social Justice and Empowerment

Sectors: Backward Classes

Brief: A first of its kind Venture Capital Fund launched by Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, Government of India to promote entrepreneurship in India among the Backward Classes by providing concessional finance to them.

Eligibility Criteria:

- The following are the eligibility criteria for prospective Companies promoted by Backward Classes entrepreneurs in the country for seeking assistance under the fund:
- The projects being set up in manufacturing, services sector, and allied sectors ensuring asset creation out of the funds deployed.
- Start-ups would also be eligible for finance as per the scheme guidelines.
- Women and disabled Backward Classes entrepreneurs will be preferred.
- Minimum existence and shareholding criteria:
- ✓ If assistance is below Rs. 50 Lakh - Companies having at least 51% stake holdings by Backward Classes entrepreneurs for the past 6 months with management control OR a new Company provided that the new Company is a successor entity of a Proprietary Firm or Partnership Firm or One Person Company (OPC) or Limited Liability Partnership (LLP) or any other establishment incorporated under any law in force, with the sound business model which has been in operation for over 6 months, and the predecessor entity had at least 51% shareholding of the Backward Classes promoters with management control.
- ✓ If assistance is above Rs.50 lakh - Companies having at least 51% stake holdings by Backward Classes entrepreneurs for the past 12 months with management control OR a new Company provided that the new Company is a successor entity of a Proprietary Firm or Partnership Firm or One Person Company (OPC) or Limited Liability Partnership (LLP) or any other establishment incorporated under any law in force, with the sound business model which has been in operation for over 12 months, and the predecessor entity had at least 51% shareholding of the Backward Classes promoters with management control.
- Documentary proofs of being Backward Classes will have to be submitted.

Benefits:

- Funding assistance from Rs. 20 lakhs up to Rs. 15 cr.
- Coupon - 6% p.a. (5.75% for women/ Divyang BC entrepreneurs)
- Investment Period in Company – Up to 10 years including moratorium upto 36 months.

Benefit Tags: Funding

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- Rs. 20 lakhs to Rs. 15 Crore Aggregate assistance not more than two times the current net worth of the Company.
- Investment under the fund will be categorized as follows: • Financial assistance upto Rs. 5 crore - Investment under this category shall be funded maximum upto 75% of the project cost and the balance 25% of the project cost will be funded by the promoters or through Government subsidy/grants under various schemes of central or state Government. In cases where Government subsidy is available, the promoters will have to contribute at least 15% of the project cost. • Financial assistance above Rs. 5 crore– Investment under this category shall be funded maximum upto 50% of the project cost. At least 25% of the project cost shall be funded by promoters or through Government subsidy/grants under various schemes of central or state Government, and balance 25% of the project cost can be funded either by promoters or by the bank or any other Financial Institutions as the case may be. In cases where Government subsidy is available, the promoters will have to contribute at least 15% of the project cost.

Apply: https://www.vcfsc.in/vcfbc/index.html

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59. Venture Capital Fund for Scheduled Castes (VCF-SC)

Ministry: Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment (MoSJE)

Department: Department of Social Justice and Empowerment

Sectors: Scheduled Castes

Brief: Venture Capital Fund for Scheduled Castes (VCF-SC), a scheme launched by the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment (MoSJE), Government of India (GOI) was launched in January 2015 for promoting entrepreneurship and provide concessional finance to the companies promoted by Scheduled Caste entrepreneurs.

Eligibility Criteria:

- The projects/units being set up in manufacturing, services, and allied sector, including start-ups and units being incubated in the technology business incubators, ensuring asset creation out of the funds deployed in the unit shall be considered.
- For Companies applying for assistance up to Rs. 50 lakh: Companies having at least 51% shareholding by Scheduled Castes entrepreneurs for the past 6 months with management control OR; a new Company provided that the new Company is a successor entity of a Proprietary Firm or Partnership Firm or One Person Company (OPC) or Limited Liability Partnership (LLP) or any other establishment incorporated under any law in force with sound business model which has been in operation for over 6 months, and the predecessor entity had at least 51% shareholding of the Scheduled Castes entrepreneurs with management control.

- For Companies applying for assistance above Rs. 50 lakh: Companies having at least 51% shareholding by Scheduled Castes entrepreneurs for the past 12 months with management control OR; a new Company provided that the new Company is a successor entity of a Proprietary Firm or Partnership Firm or One Person Company (OPC) or Limited Liability Partnership (LLP) or any other establishment incorporated under any law in force with sound business model which has been in operation for over 12 months, and the predecessor entity had at least 51% shareholding of the Scheduled Castes entrepreneurs with management control.

Benefits:

- Financial assistance from Rs. 10 lakhs to Rs. 15 Crore
- Coupon - 4% p.a. (3.75% for women/ Divyang SC entrepreneurs)
- Investment Period in Company – Up to 10 years including moratorium upto 36 months.

Benefit Tags: Funding

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- Rs. 10 lakhs to Rs. 15 Crore. Aggregate assistance not more than two times the current net worth of the Company.
- Investment under the fund will be categorized as follows: 1. 2. Financial assistance upto Rs.5 Crore - Investment under this category shall be funded maximum upto 75% of the project cost and the balance 25% of the project cost will be funded by the promoters or through Govt subsidy under various schemes of central or state Govt.; Financial assistance above Rs. 5 Crore – Investment under this category shall be funded maximum upto 50% of the project cost. At least 25% of the project cost shall be funded by promoters or through Govt subsidy under various schemes of central or state Govt., and balance 25% of the project cost can be funded either by promoters or by the bank or any other Financial Institutions as the case may be. In cases where Govt. subsidy is available, the promoters will have to contribute at least 15% of the project cost.

Tenure: Active

Apply: https://www.vcfsc.in/index.html

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60. National Handicrafts Development Program

Ministry: Ministry of Textiles

Sectors: Handicrafts

Brief: The NHDP scheme envisages a package of support to the handicraft clusters and artisans which inter-alia include basic inputs and infrastructure support in addition to capacity enhancement to cater to target market.

Eligibility Criteria:

- The eligibility criteria are different for different components under this scheme, please refer to the NHDP document for more details.

Benefits:

- The National Handicrafts Development Programme has the following components-
- 1. Marketing Support & Services- Marketing plays a vital role in the development of the handicrafts sector in India. Effort is made to provide varied marketing platforms giving ample opportunities for business development and income generation to artisans across the country.
- 2. Skill Development in Handicraft Sector- The "Skill Development in Handicraft Sector" sub-scheme meets the evolving needs of traditional crafts by offering training in modern production methods, skilled labor, design databases, prototyping, and essential soft skills.
- 3. Ambedkar Hastshilp Vikas Yojana- Ambedkar Hastshilp Vikas Yojana (AHVY) focuses on small artisan clusters, providing comprehensive support for up to three years. It aims to boost employment, upgrade technology, enhance competitiveness, assist with design and marketing, and promote brands, among other initiatives.
- 4. Direct Benefit to Artisans [Welfare]- This scheme is proposed to support the artisans during their old age. The scheme is designed to give a boost to the handicraft sector in India.
- 5. Infrastructure and Technology Support- The sub-scheme “Infrastructure and Technology Support” aims to develop world-class infrastructure in the country to support handicraft production, enhance product quality, and reduce costs to enable it to compete in the global market.
- 6. Research & Development- The Research & Development Scheme is introduced to generate feedback on economic, social, aesthetic, and promotional aspects of various crafts and artisans in the handicraft sector.
- For more information regarding these components and how they’ll benefit the artisans across the country, please refer to the NHDP document from the link below.

Benefit Tags: Skill Development

Tenure: 2022-23 to 2025-26

Apply: https://handicrafts.nic.in/pdf/Scheme.pdf#page=3

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61. National Handloom Development Programme

Ministry: Ministry of Textiles

Sectors: Handloom

Brief: The NHDP is an attempt to facilitate the sustainable development of handloom weavers located in and outside identified handloom clusters into a cohesive, self-managing and competitive socio-economic unit.

Eligibility Criteria:

- The scheme has several components and eligibility varies for each of these. Please refer to the NHDP document for more details.

Benefits:

- Financial Support This program emphasized providing financial assistance to the handloom industries for the cluster projects, i.e., the projects where the weavers are in a formidable unit. The overall revenue of the finest that is provided to the handloom weavers is set as ₹2 Crore per project.
- General Awareness One of the key components of the National Handloom Development program is to provide general awareness among the weavers. The awareness of this handloom industry requires the knowledge of the product range, what must be the weaver’s income, the category of the yarn as well as the market demand.
- Marketing Assistance This program also provides marketing assistance, which includes marketing infrastructure development, market access initiative, domestic marketing, promotion, etc.
- Consensual Credit Certain kinds of credit are provided to the handloom weavers under the aspect of this development program, which includes the interest subsidy, margin money assistant, bunker facilitator, credit guarantee, etc.

Benefit Tags: Acceleration

Tenure: 2021-22 to 2025-26

Apply: http://handlooms.nic.in/assets/img/Handloom%20Schemes/final%20book%208%20Nov%2021.pdf

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62. Raw Material Supply Scheme

Ministry: Ministry of Textiles

Sectors: Handloom

Brief: The Ministry of Textiles introduces the Raw Material Supply Scheme, which is designed to ensure the availability of quality raw materials to handloom weavers and artisans. This scheme supports the handloom sector by providing reliable access to essential raw materials.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Individual weavers.
- Agencies in which weavers are members i.e. Self Help Groups (SHGs), Joint Liability Groups (JLGs) and Cooperative Societies.
- Handloom Producer Company.
- Weavers Entrepreneurs Entrepreneurs, who are involved in actual weaving activity along with marketing and other activities & own Handlooms on their premises, will be eligible weaver entrepreneurs.
- The number of Handlooms owned and functional in the premises of the weaver entrepreneur will be counted for the raw material subsidy component purpose.

Benefits:

- Transport Subsidy Component: The purpose of this component is to make available all types of yarn at mill gate price to the beneficiaries for production of handloom items, so as to facilitate regular supply of basic raw materials to the Handloom sector and help utilize the full employment potential of the sector. Price Subsidy on Raw Material: The objective of this component of the scheme is to make available raw material.. yarn at a subsidized price to the eligible beneficiaries so as to facilitate the handloom sector to compete with the mill sector.

Benefit Tags: Infrastructure

Tenure: 2021-22 to 2025-26

Apply: http://handlooms.nic.in/assets/img/Handloom%20Schemes/final%20book%208%20Nov%2021.pdf

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63. VENTURE CAPITAL FUND FOR SCHEDULED TRIBES (VCF-ST)

Ministry: Ministry of Tribal Affairs (MoTA)

Sectors: Scheduled Tribes

Brief: Venture Capital Fund for Scheduled Tribes (VCFST), a scheme was launched on February 10, 2024 by Hon'ble Union Minister for Tribal Affairs (MoTA), Government of India (GoI) Shri Arjun Munda in the gracious presence of Hon'ble President Smt. Draupadi Murmur. The scheme Venture Capital Fund for Scheduled Tribes (VCFST) is launched to promote entrepreneurship and to support innovative ideas through Technology Business Incubators by providing concessional finance to the companies promoted by Scheduled Tribes entrepreneurs.

Eligibility Criteria:

- The projects/units being setup in the manufacturing, services and allied sector, including start-ups and units being incubated in the technology business incubators, ensuring asset creation out of the funds deployed in the units shall be considered.
- **A. For Companies applying for assistance up to Rs.50 lakh: Companies having :**
- i. at least 51% shareholding by Scheduled Tribes entrepreneurs for the past 6 months with the management control OR;
- ii. a new Company provided that the new company is a successor entity of Proprietary Firm or One Person Company (OPC) or Limited Liability (LLP) or any other establishment incorporated under any law in force with sound business model which has been in operation for over 6 months, and the predecessor entity had at least 51% shareholding of the Scheduled Tribes entrepreneurs with management control.
- **B. For Companies applying for assistance above Rs.50 lakh: Companies having :**
- i. At least 51% shareholding by Scheduled Tribes entrepreneurs for the past 12 months with management control OR;
- ii. a new Company provided that the new company is a successor entity of Proprietary Firm or One Person Company (OPC) or Limited Liability (LLP) or any other establishment incorporated under any law in force with sound business model which has been in operation for over 12 months, and the predecessor entity had at least 51% shareholding of the Scheduled Tribes entrepreneurs with management control.
- **For Technology Oriented Innovative Projects:**
- A. Eligibility Criteria for technology oriented innovative projects Innovative ideas selected by Technology Business Incubators (TBIs) for incubation funding to cover the cost of carrying out innovation projects subject to a ceiling of Rs.10 lakhs on an average year for a period of three years aggregating Rs.30 lakhs subject to satisfactory progress. Or;
- B. New Companies having at least 51% shareholding by first time Scheduled Tribes entrepreneurs who have been working in technology oriented innovative projects:
- i. With the support of incubation centers at IITs, NITs, Premier Business Schools, Universities, Institutions, Medical Colleges, NSTEDB under Department of Science & Technology (DST) or supported by corporates, with good potential of commercialization and project is at implementation stage.
- ii. Projects sanctioned by Departments/Ministries of Government of India after due appraisal.

Benefits:

- Funding assistance from Rs.10 lakh to Rs.5 crore
- Funding of up to Rs.30 lakhs over a three-year period as equity (Technology Oriented Projects)
- Coupon - 4% p.a. (3.75% for women/ Divyang ST entrepreneurs)
- Investment Period in Company – Up to 10 years including moratorium upto 36 months.

Benefit Tags: Funding

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- The initial corpus to begin the scheme is Rs.21.50 crore with Rs.20 crore contribution by Ministry of Tribal Affairs, Government of India and Rs.1 crore contribution by Tribal Cooperative Marketing Development Federation of India.

Tenure: Active

Apply: https://vcfst.in/

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64. NABVENTURES Fund

Ministry: National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)

Sectors: Agtech, Animal Husbandry , Aquaculture, Agri - Biotech, Supply Chain Solutions, Climate Resilient Agriculture, Food Processing, Regional Food Brands, Health And Welness Foods, Food Logistics, Supply Chain Monitoring Solutions, Biotech In Food, Financial Inclusion, Rural / Agri Focused NBFCs, Rural / Agri Fintechs, Rural Healthcare, Rural Education

Brief: NABVENTURES is a venture growth equity fund that invests in agriculture, food, rural businesses and agri/rural financial services at early to mid-stage. The fund invests in asset-light business models, high on innovation/technology, solving large problems in agriculture, food and rural development through innovative means.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Type of Business: Startups registered as private limited companies or limited liability partnerships (LLPs) in India, engaged in agriculture, agtech, agri-biotech, food, agri rural fintech, and rural businesses.
- Stage of Development: Early to mid-stage ventures with innovative and scalable business models, demonstrating the potential for high impact and positive contribution to relevant sectors.
- Financial Performance: Minimum annual turnover of Rs. 25 lakhs for profit-making companies or demonstrably positive unit economics for pre-revenue ventures.
- Team Expertise: Strong and experienced founding team with relevant domain knowledge and business acumen.

Benefits:

- Financial Investment: Access to equity and equity-linked investments ranging from Rs. 5 crores to Rs. 20 crores per round, with potential for follow-on funding.
- Mentorship and Guidance: Support from experienced mentors and industry experts in areas like business development, fundraising, strategy, and operations.
- Networking Opportunities: Connection with potential investors, partners, and other stakeholders within the relevant ecosystem.
- Brand Recognition: Affiliation with a reputable organization like NABARD can enhance venture credibility and attract further interest.
- Market Access: Assistance in navigating regulatory hurdles and connecting with relevant markets and distribution channels.

Benefit Tags: Financial Benefits

Quantum/Size of Fund:

- NABVENTURES Fund I has a target corpus of Rs. 500 crores, currently with over Rs. 200 crores committed by NABARD and other investors.
- Individual investment amounts per venture typically range from Rs. 5 crores to Rs. 20 crores, with potential for higher investments based on business potential and growth stage.

Tenure: Active

Apply: https://www.nabard.org/nabard-subsidiaries.aspx?id=1721&cid=1727

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65. The Women Entrepreneurship Platform (WEP)

Ministry: Niti Aayog

Sectors: Women Entrepreneuship

Brief: NITI Aayog has launched a Women Entrepreneurship Platform (WEP) to provide an ecosystem for budding & existing women entrepreneurs across the country. SIDBI has partnered with NITI Aayog to assist in this initiative.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Potential women entrepreneurs, in collaboration with partner organizations can apply for the scheme

Benefits:

- WEP enables key partnerships to bring crucial content, workshops, campaigns and other avenues of learning and growth to its users from trailblazers in the industry.

Benefit Tags: Acceleration

Notes:

- NITI Aayog has launched a Women Entrepreneurship Platform (WEP) for providing an ecosystem for budding & existing women entrepreneurs across the country. SIDBI has partnered with NITI Aayog to assist in this initiative.

Apply: https://wep.gov.in

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66. Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana

Ministry: Public Sector Enterprise

Sectors: Non-Farm, Non-Corporate

Brief: Pradhan Mantri MUDRA Yojana (PMMY) is a scheme launched by the Hon'ble Prime Minister on April 8, 2015, for providing loans up to 10 lakh to the non-corporate, non-farm small/micro enterprises. These loans are classified as MUDRA loans under PMMY. These loans are given by Commercial Banks, RRBs, Small Finance Banks, MFIs, and NBFCs.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Any Indian Citizen who has a business plan for a non-farm income generating activity such as manufacturing, processing, trading or service sector whose credit need is up to 10 lakh can approach either a Bank, MFI or NBFC for availing of MUDRA loans under PMMY. The usual terms and conditions of the lending agency may have to be followed for availing of loans under PMMY. The lending rates are as per the RBI guidelines issued in this regard from time to time.

Benefits:

- Loans up to 10 Lahks to the non-corporate, non-farm small/micro enterprises.

Apply: https://www.mudra.org.in

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67. Samridhi Fund

Ministry: Public Sector Enterprise

Department: SIDBI

Sectors: Social Enterprises

Brief: The Samridhi Fund is an approx. ₹430 crore social venture capital fund. SIDBI has envisaged the creation of the Samridhi Fund to provide capital to social enterprises which can deliver both financial and social returns, in Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Odisha, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Rajasthan, and West Bengal.

Eligibility Criteria:

- The conditions necessary for getting funded are as follows:
- Be economically viable
- Provide access to markets for the poor
- Be socially relevant and impact the poor as customers, producers, or employees
- The enterprises must have plans to expand operations in any or all the following states – Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Uttar Pradesh, West Bengal, Madhya Pradesh, Jharkhand, and Rajasthan

- Increase the flow of capital to the above-mentioned states
- Focus on Environment, Social and Governance matters
- Samridhi will not invest in any of the following businesses or activities:
  - Illegal or banned activities, including child labor
  - Businesses dealing with hazardous chemicals, asbestos, pesticides, and wastes; ozone-depleting substances; and endangered or protected wildlife or wildlife products.
  - Arms and ammunition
  - Companies that have been proven to be involved in fraud and corruption.

Benefits:

- ₹430 crore social venture capital fund

Apply: https://www.startupindia.gov.in/content/sih/en/government-schemes/samridhi_fund.html

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68. Stand Up India

Ministry: Public Sector Enterprise

Sectors: Sector Agnostic Eligibility

Brief: Stand Up India Scheme facilitates bank loans between 10 lakh and 1 crore to at least one scheduled caste (SC) or Scheduled Tribe, borrower, and at least one woman per bank branch for setting up a greenfield enterprise. This enterprise may be in manufacturing, services, or the trading sector. In case of non-individual enterprises at least 51% of the shareholding and controlling stake should be held by either an SC/ST or Woman entrepreneur.

Eligibility Criteria:

- SC/ST and/or women entrepreneurs; above 18 years of age
- Loans under the scheme are available for only greenfield projects. Greenfield signifies, in this context, the first-time venture of the beneficiary in the manufacturing or services or trading
- In the case of non-individual enterprises,51% of the shareholding and controlling stakes should be held by either SC/ST and/or Women Entrepreneur
- Borrower should not be in default to any bank or financial institution

Benefits:

- Loans between 10 lakh and 1 Crore

Apply: https://www.standupmitra.in/Home/SUISchemes

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69. Venture Capital by SIDBI Venture Capital Ltd. (SVLC)

Ministry: Public Sector Enterprise

Department: SIDBI

Sectors: Finance

Brief: They aim to work for best returns by investing in deserving entrepreneurial teams using a combination of capital, strategic mentoring, skills and our vast network of relationships.

Eligibility Criteria:

- A strong committed management team, established performance record and a high degree of integrity, Sustainable competitive advantage, Scalability of operations, Potential for above average profitability, leading to attractive returns on investment, Subscription to equity/ equity-type instruments, Unlisted companies preferably MSME and Availability of exit route for Venture Capital investment.

Benefits:

- SVCL provides 'smart money' to entrepreneurs. Apart from finance, SVCL provides networking and management support as well with the objective to make the company grow rapidly. SVCL also assists investee companies to attract investment from other venture capitalists in subsequent rounds of financing.

Apply: https://sidbiventure.co.in
